



PARISH

of Aghagallon & Ballinderry

There will be a second collection this weekend for the Monthly Stipend

The annual stipend to be paid is now £23,040.00 and applies to all priests in ministry equally. This will meet Home Office requirement on 'sponsoring international workers' i.e. international priests ministering in the Diocese. To ensure we continue to cover a resident priest our monthly stipend needs to be £1,920.00 per month before tax.

Growing In Faith Together Programme Monday 14th Sep 2026 in Aghagallon Community Centre from 7.30pm-9pm for Year 8's. Applications forms have been sent out, if you did not receive one come along with an adult on the first evening to complete an application form.

Children's Liturgy If you wish to present your son/daughter for any sacraments this year then they must attend Mass on a regular basis. **What does a regular basis mean?** Catholics are obliged to attend Mass once a week, a Saturday Evening Vigil or Sunday, and on Holy Days of Obligation. All of your family are very welcome at any Mass, don't worry about little ones making noise, they are just saying their prayers in their own way. Children's Liturgy will begin on Sunday 13th September 2026 at 11am Mass.

New School Year Mass The pupils and staff from St Mary's and St Patrick's Primary School's will join us for Mass on Wednesday 16th September 2026 at 10am. Everyone Welcome.

Dear Lord Jesus, watch over our children as they begin this new school year. Keep them safe, happy, and strong. Guide their hearts and minds, help them to be kind and respectful, and give them courage when things are difficult.

Bless their teachers, friends, and families, and help them grow in wisdom, faith, and love.

Amen.

WEEKLY BULLETIN

Sunday 6th September 2026

Weekly Collection
£1,175.00
Online
£94.83
Total: £1,269.83

Thank you for your continued support

The Sanctuary Lamp will burn this week for a Special Intention

Weekly Mass Schedule

7th Sep – 13th Sep 2026

Mass

Monday: 10.00am
Tuesday: 7.00pm
Wednesday: 10.00am
Thursday: 10.00am
Saturday: 7.00pm
(Vigil)
Sunday: 9am & 11am

Adoration

Wednesday 10am-6pm

Liturgy of the Word

Friday: 10am

MINISTRY OF WELCOME

We welcome Baby Daisy

who was baptised recently into our Parish family

Booking Masses, Baptisms and Weddings As parish office opening hours have been reduced slightly, we are returning to our previous practice of booking Masses, baptisms and weddings in person, in the sacristy after Masses.

Masses can be booked well in advance to ensure your preferred dates are available.
Baptisms can only be booked by the child's parent or legal guardian. At least one month's notice is required. To book a baptism parents must present the child's long birth certificate, complete the baptism request form, meet with one of our Baptism team and attend weekly Mass during the month prior to the date of the Baptism

Weddings can be booked by the couple themselves. Couples are required to give at least six months' notice of marriage to ensure the preferred date is available and that there is adequate time to complete all Civil and Church paperwork.

RECENTLY DECEASED

Brian McGarry

Tom Dowdall

Mary Orr

Iris Craig

Michelle Latimer (nee Rush) Month's Mind Mass Sunday 13th September at 9am

ANNIVERSARIES AT THIS TIME

Sean Toomey

Deceased members of the McKay Family

Deceased members of the Campbell Family

Patrick McCrystal

Colin Toomey

Pat Lavery

Barry Geraghty

Seamus Nelson

Robert McVeigh (Sen)

Dolores Cushley

Lottie Lavery

Seamus Loughran (8)

Sean McKavanagh

Jim McGarrell (37)

Stephen McGarrell(9)

Brigid Skelton (22)

Kathleen Brankin

Joe McCavigan

Aghagallon Community Centre Mother and Toddler group resumes on Friday 11th September 2026, 10am-11.30am

Parish Office Tel: 02892 651214

Email: parishofaandb@yahoo.co.uk

Parish Priest: Fr Declan Mulligan

02892651214

Parish Office Mobile:

Catherine 07485605252

EMERGENCIES AND SICK CALLS

07831 934 756

(in the event you are unable to reach Fr Declan on the emergency number)

02894 422278

St Vincent De Paul

Contact Number:

07598 076585

www.svp.ie

Lifeline Freephone 0808 808 8000

The Knights of St Columbanus

028 92 528 916

Diocesan Safeguarding Office

028 9049 2798

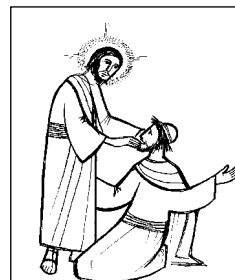
Parish Office Open Tue, Wed & Fri 11am-3pm

All insertions for the bulletin – please leave in the Parochial house red post box, email or phone the parish office before 4pm on Tuesday.

6th SEPTEMBER 2026 — 23rd SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

PARISH OF ANTRIM
St Comgall, St Joseph, St MacNissius

Rev Patrick Mulholland PP, St Comgall's Presbytery: 94428016
 Rev David Aksenczuk, St Joseph's Presbytery: 07935340359
 Parish Support Officer: Mrs Bernie Mann: 94428016
 Antrim Parish website www.antrimparish.com
 Facebook: [Parish of Antrim](https://www.facebook.com/Parish of Antrim)

**SUNDAY MASSES**

St. Comgall's 9.00am 11.00am
 St. Joseph's 5.30pm (Sat vigil) 12.00noon
 St. MacNissius 10.00am

Weekday Mass

St. Comgall's: Monday, Wed, Friday & Sat 10.00am
 St. Joseph's: Tues & Thurs 10am Fri 7pm

Mass is available to view on the Parish
 facebook page and youtube: Parish of
 Antrim

Confessions

St. Comgall's – Sat 12 - 12.30pm
 St. Joseph's – Sat 4.45 – 5.15pm

Adoration: Fri 10.30 – 12 noon St. Comgall's
 Every 1st Fri. @ 6pm St. Joseph's

Prayer Group – Every Wed 7pm in Sr.
 Catherine's Room
 St. Comgall's

Readings: Sunday Cycle A 23rd
 Sunday of the Year Weekday Cycle 2

PRAYER OF THE DAY

*We give you thanks, God of love and
 compassion that you continue to
 believe in our goodness. We want to
 share with others the gifts and graces
 we have received so we may become a
 community of love and peace,
 reconciling and being reconciled.
 Help us to recognise the giftedness of
 others.*

Thought for the Week

*'Occupy yourself in beholding
 and bewailing your own
 imperfections rather than
 contemplating the
 imperfections of others.'*

St. Ignatius of Loyola

PRAYER PEOPLE

Intention for Parish Community Year 13
Week 42

*We pray for all parishioners who are
 parents that they will trust God to
 guide them in their parenting.*

Offertory Collection: £3,664.00
Thank you to all who contributed.

Recently Deceased: Tony Gallinagh (Enniskillen)

Month's Mind:

Anniv Sharon Dowd, Veronica & Sandra McCollum, Kathleen Boyle, Paul Murray,
 Hugh Kelly, Sean Drain, Josephine Scally, Frances McGuigan,

CEMETERY SUNDAYS IN PARISH

Prayers for the Deceased will take place at 3pm on:

Sunday 6th September in Belmont Cemetery (Gather for prayers at the Sixmile Cemetery end).

Sunday 13th September in St Comgall's Cemetery.

(a collection will be taken up to defray expenses for the services)

Mass of Thanksgiving and Farewell to Fr Sean.

Will take place on Friday 11th September at 7pm in St. Joseph's Church.

Followed by a Presentation to Fr Sean and refreshments will be available. Everyone is very welcome to attend.

The Medical Missionaries of Mary have been invited to visit us in Down and Connor this year and will be with us here at Antrim Parish on this weekend of 5th and 6th September 2026. They will speak of their work, mainly in Africa and South America, and their mission to bring Christ's healing love to those most in need. Our parish and our diocese have supported MMM generously in the past, both in finance and in prayer, and MMM wishes to express gratitude for that support and to emphasise that we here at home are the body of mission, and those who are sent to far away places are the hands and the feet. When they speak to us and share their story they serve as a connection between us and those whom they serve.

Healing Night will be this Sunday 20th September at 6pm. There will be Eucharistic Adoration, confession and an opportunity for quiet individual prayer and music.

TEA AND COFFEE MORNING The social and hospitality would love you all to come and join us for a cuppa and some refreshments on Sunday 20th September in St Comgall's Youth Centre after 11am Mass. Bring your family and friends – everyone is welcome.

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20).

The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

"MEDJUGORJE YOUTH PILGRIMAGE 2027": Our Youth Minister Dean Millar will be taking a group of young people aged 14 - 18 from Antrim, Randalstown & Duneane Parishes to Medjugorje next summer. If you would be interested in this, please share an expression of interest with Dean at d.millar@downandconnor.org or via Whatsapp at 07593 925676

Prayer after Communion

Soul of Christ, sanctify me;

Body of Christ, save me;

Blood of Christ, fill me;

Water from the side of Christ, wash me;

Passion of Christ, strengthen me, O Good Jesus hear me

Within your wounds hide me; allow me not to be separated from you;

From the malicious enemy defend me;

At the hour of my death call me;

And bid me come to you, that with your saints I will praise you forever and ever. Amen

6th SEPTEMBER 2026
23rd SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

Priest: With humble hearts, we turn to God, who is rich in mercy and always ready to forgive. Let us bring before Him the needs of our Church and our world

For the Church, that she may faithfully proclaim Christ crucified and risen, and guide all people in the path of discipleship and hope.

Let us pray to the Lord

For governments, financial institutions, and world leaders, that they may act with wisdom, fairness, and concern for the most vulnerable, placing human dignity above financial gain..

Let us pray to the Lord.

For those who carry anger, hurt, or resentment, that they may find the grace to forgive and the courage to seek healing and peace

Let us pray to the Lord

For nations struggling under the weight of debt, that their leaders may find just and compassionate solutions, and that international cooperation may bring hope, stability, and dignity to their people.

Let us pray to the Lord

For communities affected by poverty and economic hardship, that families may have access to food, shelter, education, and opportunities to build a better future

For all who are sick or suffering, burdened or bereaved, that they will experience the healing love of God in their lives.

Let us pray to the Lord

For those who have died:

Recently Deceased: Tony Gallinagh (Enniskillen)

All those named in the bulletin.

that they may share in the glory of Christ's resurrection and receive the reward promised to His faithful disciples.

Let us pray to the Lord

Priest: Merciful Father, hear our prayers. Help us to forgive as we have been forgiven, and guide us always in the way of love, reconciliation, and peace. We ask this through Christ our Lord **Amen.**



Parish Bulletin

for
Ramoan

(Ballycastle, Glenshesk & Rathlin)
and

Ballintoy & Ballinlea
(Mass Readings: Sunday Cycle A)

Parish Emergency Mobile: 07809553349.
www.ballycastleparish.com

Parish Office, Mon-Fri 9am-2pm: 20762223
ballycastle@downandconnor.org

Mass and Confessions Schedule in Ballycastle

Vigil Mass on Saturday at 6.30pm, and Masses on Sunday at 10am and 12noon.
Daily Mass: 10am, with Sacrament of Reconciliation after Saturday 10am Mass

Upcoming Mass Schedule

Ballintoy: Sat 5th Sept at 5.30pm Glenshesk: Sun 13th Sept at 9am. Ballinlea: Sun 20th Sept at 9am.

Youth Choir

🎵 Every other Saturday starting Saturday 5th Sept with 5.15pm rehearsal for 6.30pm Mass.
New members welcome. Age: P4 upwards
Contact Noilin 07852263060

Lough Derg

One Day Retreats

of guided prayer and reflection are available on September 9th, 12th, 15th, 19th & 20th
Further information at www.loughderg.org or info@loughderg.org



The Causeway Coast Peace Group

meet on Tuesday, 8th September, 10am-12noon (Tea / Coffee 10-10.30am)
in Ballintoy Parish Church Hall with speaker Shona McCarthy
on the theme "Peace Through a Creative Lens".
New members / attendees always welcome

We extend a warm welcome

The Rev Emma Gibson

**who was formally instituted as rector of the Church of Ireland
Parishes of Ramoan and Culfeightrin on Friday 4th September.**

The Legion of Mary Annual Pilgrimage

to Knock Shrine will take place on Sun 27 Sept.
A coach will leave Dunloy Parish Centre at 7am, returning by 9.30pm.
Information / booking: 07510547636 (Legion of Mary)

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

Portglenone Monastery, Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.
The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20).
and will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.
All men are very welcome.
For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Temporary Building Supervisor required at St Olcan's Primary School, Armoy for 18.5 hrs per week with immediate start, initially for 1 month but may be extended; experience preferred.

Please send your CV to mkennedy502@c2kni.net if you would be interested in this post.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament

every Monday, immediately after 10am Mass until 1.30pm. All welcome

We pray for our deceased parishioners, relatives and friends, especially those who died recently

Seamus Walsh (Leyland Farm),
Dermot Hurley (Castle Street; originally Maghera),
Michael McConville (Belfast & formerly Ballycastle) and
Patrick McGothigan (Germany; originally Magherahoney)

and those whose anniversaries occur at this time

Robbie Elliot (1st), Kieran Grant (1st), Joseph McAuley, Maureen & James Forrester, Francie Black,
John McLaughlin, Annie McCaughan, Mary Ann Bakewell, Jimmy Gibson, Mary Girvan,
Patrick & Maureen Hetherington, Andrew McLernon and Francie McGinty

Requiescant in Pace

We welcome
*to the worshipping community of the parishes of
Ramoan, Ballycastle and of Ballintoy*

Aran Taylor
Ben Taylor
Eiblinn McCaughan
Jack Tolan
Leo McLean
Arlo Whelan-Neill
Naoise Whelan-Neill
Grace Connolly
Orlaith Connolly
Rian Soave
Blanaid McCaughan
Oisin McAlonan
Kaleb Farrelly
Brianna McAfee

who were baptised over the last two months.



Baptism is the gateway to life in the Spirit and the door which gives access to the other sacraments. Through Baptism we are freed from sin and reborn as children of God; and become members of Christ.

Apostolic Work collection totalled £1,008.20. Thank you to all who contributed and special thanks to SVdP, and to Bridie O'Neill and Riona for helping out on the day.



The Foodbank is very much in need of tinned veg (e.g. peas and carrots), tinned meats (e.g. tuna, corned beef and ham), packets of biscuits (e.g. digestives and kitkats), tinned rice and custard.



Al Anon

If you are concerned about a loved ones drinking, you are not alone.
Ballycastle Al Anon family group meet every Monday in 62 Ann St, from 6 to 7pm.

Please note change of venue, day and time.

Newcomers are very welcome

Confidential helplines: 08000086811 and 028-90682368.

Email: helpline@al-anonuk.org.uk

Day trip to Knock

Saturday 3rd October. Bus leaving St Patrick's Church Loughguile at 6am.

Contact Patricia Campbell on 028-27641120 or 07871626940. Price approx £30 depending on numbers.

Useful numbers

Saint Vincent de Paul 07754722022.

Bethany Bereavement Support 07519471481.

Foodbank 07536986448.

BabyBank 07801630476 or 07929785256.

Legion of Mary 07510547636.

Vincent's Shop – open Monday – Friday - 9 00-5 00pm.
 Telephone 2564 4122 Helpline Tel No 078 4048 2141

Parish Centre Telephone Number – 028 2563 1236



Why not join us after 10 00am Mass for tea, coffee, and some light snacks in the Main Hall, Parish Centre. There will also be juice and nibbles for the younger people

The Old School Café is available for funeral receptions – various menus available. Contact 078 7977 4749. **Thursday Lunch - Contact Claire** to book.

Repository Shop – Tuesday – Friday - 10 30am-12 30pm.

Wednesday Get Together Club continues - 9 September – 2 00pm-4 00pm. Come and 'Play your card right'.

All Saints' Men's Group new project – Friday Club for Seniors (ladies and gents) continues – 11am. Pick up a leaflet from Parish Centre office of Café.

Bingo continues – Sundays - 7 30pm.

Yoga recommences – Tuesday 8 September. Contact Terence 07808 303 408.

Parish Whist Drive recommences – Thursday 10 September – 7 30pm.

All Saints' Men's Club (Seniors) – Wednesday - 11am (after Mass). New members welcome. No upper age limit.

Ladies Activity Class recommences – Monday 14 September – 11 00am-12noon. New members welcome.

Creative Crafters recommences – Monday 14 September – after 10 00am Mass

Pitter Patter Parents & Toddlers recommences – Monday 14 September – 10 00am-11.45am – All Saints' Youth Club.



23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time 6 September 2026

Our Parish vision:

Our Parish is a caring community, leading people into friendship with Christ and sending them out to serve, bring hope and enrich lives.

Church of All Saints - Saturday 6 00pm Vigil, Sunday 8 30am, Sunday 10 00am, Sunday **2 00pm Polish Mass**

St Patrick's Church - Saturday 5 00pm Vigil, Sunday 11 00am

Eucharistic Adoration each Friday 10 30am-12noon

Confessions – Saturday 12noon-1 00pm
First Fridays 7 00pm-7 30pm. Mass at 7 30pm

Weekly collection £4111

Thank you for your generosity.

Parish Office Tel: 028 2564 1515 – weekdays 9am-12noon

Facebook Page: Ballymena Kirkinriola Parish

Youtube: All saints ballymena

. Website: ballymenaparish.org

Email: ballymena@downandconnor.org

If you are new to the parish, you are invited to register at the Parish Office and collect an Information Pack for new Ballymena parishioners

Weekend Masses at 5pm & 6pm (vigils) and 10am & 11am will be transmitted via YouTube and 6pm and 10am via Parish Radio
Daily Mass at 10am transmitted via Youtube and Parish Radio

Parish Website [www.ballymenaparish.org](https://ballymenaparish.org)



We welcome those who were Baptised recently in the parish: Finley John McKay, Koa Theodore McMenamin

Recently deceased: Michael McConville (Nazareth Care Village)

Month's Mind: Patricia Murray, Denis Hopkins

Anniversaries: John & Eilish Smith, Sheila Killough, Jim McReynolds, Patricia Doherty, Gerry Bradley, Eileen Dillon, Thomas O'Kane, Archdeacon Kevin Donnelly, Samuel & Mary Carbery, Annie Walsh (nee Kelly), Mary McMullan, John Mcallister, Kathleen McMullan, Mary McKenna, Alaster McWilliams, Kevin Neeson, Kathleen McAlinden, Margaret McGinn, Kathleen McQuillan, Roy Spurgeon

The Medical Missionaries of Mary have been invited to visit us in Down and Connor this year and will be with us here at Ballymena Parish on the weekend of **5th and 6th September**. They will speak of their work, mainly in Africa and South America, and their mission to bring Christ's healing love to those most in need.

Awaken – 'Wake up sleeper, rise from the dead, and Christ will shine on you.' **Ephesians 5:14** Along with the other Christian denominations we are invited to pray for the people of Ballymena and beyond for the conversion of hearts and minds to Jesus Christ who is Lord of all. This is a week long 24/7 event: **Sunday 6th – Sunday 13th September**. You are invited to spend some time at **All Saints' Church (8.30am – 6pm each day) in prayer**. There is also a dedicated Prayer Room available in the All Saints' Parish Centre on **Wednesday 9 September (7 00pm-9 00pm)**. Everyone is welcome.

Eucharistic Adoration – Down and Connor Diocese is renewing and developing its **Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee** in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting at **ONE** of these venues:

Thursday 1 October – The Parish Centre Ballymena – 8 00pm

Friday 2 October – St Patrick's Centre Downpatrick – 8 00pm

Registration from 7 30pm. See poster in the church for details.

Children's Liturgy -We will shortly be restarting Children's liturgy following the summer break for pupils in P1 -7.

Children's liturgy is a wonderful way for children to engage with the gospel message and the good news of Jesus through storytelling, discussion, singing and prayer. **The liturgy will take place in the Parish Centre during the Sunday 10am Mass from mid September.** Only children who have started Primary School and have been registered by a parent/guardian to attend can leave the church to attend. For new registrations please contact Claire on clarhanna@gmail.com or 07415653854.

Irish Classes in All Saints' Parsh Centre - 10 weeks - beginning - Thursday 17th September. Minor Hall 07:00pm - 08:00pm – Irish Language Improver's Class Slemish Room 07:00pm - 08:00pm – Irish Language Beginner's Class. Please book early as numbers are restricted. Braid Room 07:00pm - 08:00pm – Irish Language Advanced class. **Please contact Rosie Lyness on 07740684152 for further details.**

OCIA/RCIA - Adults, who are interested in finding out more about our Catholic faith, thinking about joining our Catholic community or existing Catholics, who wish to learn more about the basics of our faith, please contact the Parish Office and complete a registration form by **Friday 18th September**.

Volunteers urgently required in a variety of areas in the parish. If you would be interested, please leave your name and contact details into the parish office and Fr Michael will contact you.

Down & Connor Cantor Training – Music Ministry Formation for adults (18+) ready to serve more fully in parish music ministry. Training will take place in St Joseph's Parish Centre Dunloy – 3rd & 17th October & 7th November. To request an application form or for more information please contact the Pathways team at pathwaystothefuture@downandconnor.org

If you know of anyone who has recently become housebound and would like a visit from a priest, please contact the parish office.

The CONNECT friendship group will meet in Mezo's cafe, Broughshane Street, on Sunday 6th Sept 7pm. Everyone welcome. (over 18).



Parish of Ballymoney
& Derrykeighan

CAUSEWAY FAMILY OF PARISHES

6th September 2026
Twenty Third Sunday of Ordinary Time



HOW TO DEAL WITH COMPLAINTS

This Sunday's readings tackle a subject we all find awkward: how to give and receive criticism. In the first reading, Ezekiel is called by God to speak out against sin, even though he cannot guarantee people will listen. In the Gospel, Jesus gives practical advice for confronting someone who has wronged us — first privately, then with a friend, always seeking reconciliation rather than revenge.

The lesson is one of patient love. We shouldn't gossip or hold grudges, but speak honestly and calmly, wanting the relationship restored rather than "winning." Sometimes the wisest course is to wait until we can speak without anger. And when we ourselves feel let down, even by God, we're free to bring him our complaints too — he can bear them.

THIS WEEK

Parish webcam can be viewed on our YouTube channel
(search for Ballymoney Parish)

SUNDAY 6th	9.30am Mass
MONDAY 7th	10am Mass
WEDNESDAY 9th	10am Mass 7pm Rosary
FRIDAY 11th	6pm Adoration & Confessions 7pm Mass
SATURDAY 12th	5.30-5.50pm Confessions 6pm Mass

Our Lady & St Patrick's church is open every day
for private prayer - usually from 10am to 7pm.

Other Sunday Masses in the Causeway Family of Parishes

Saturday 4.30pm	-	Portstewart
Sunday 10am	-	Portstewart
Sunday 11.30am	-	St Malachy's, Coleraine
Sunday 12noon	-	Portrush
Sunday 5pm	-	St Malachy's, Coleraine

WE PRAY FOR THE FAITHFUL DEPARTED

Month's Mind

Frankie McEldowney

Anniversaries

Danny Coyles, Michael Coyles, James Douglas,
John & Florence Kirgan, Florena Moore

REQUIESCAT IN PACE

PARISH FINANCES

Thank you to everyone who supports the parish through our collections. If you want to request a box of envelopes there is a purple form at the back of the church. Remember that you can also support the parish through a regular standing order or by making a one off payment through your bank or online. Our account details are:

Parish of Ballymoney & Derrykeighan

Sort code: 95-06-79

Account No: 10020192.

If you want to give by cheque please make payable to:

Parish of Ballymoney & Derrykeighan.

SEASON OF CREATION

The Church's Season of Creation runs throughout September and on until the feast of St Francis of Assisi on October 4th.

Bishop Alan McGuckian writes "I warmly encourage our parishes, schools, families and communities throughout the diocese to participate in the Season of Creation. May we be inspired to take practical steps, however small, to care for God's creation and to work for environmental justice.

"May this Season of Creation deepen our gratitude for the gift of creation, strengthen our commitment to environmental justice, and inspire us to become faithful stewards of the earth entrusted to our care."

BLESSING OF PETS

Once again we will be marking the Season of Creation with a blessing of animals inspired by the ministry of St Francis of Assisi. Our pets and animals remind us of the beauty and diversity God has given us in the natural world. This year the blessing service takes place here in Ballymoney in the grounds of the church on **Sunday 27th September** at **2pm**. All welcome to attend and bring along your animals to be blessed.

ST VINCENT DE PAUL

Our parish SVP conference is here to support our local community, and we do this in the strictest confidence. If you are in need and would like our help please do not hesitate to get in touch on **07860 455 549**.



SVP ANNUAL OUTING

The Society of St Vincent de Paul, Ballymoney, are hosting their annual outing for senior citizens and those living alone on **Sunday 20th September**.

This year's event will offer a shopping trip followed by an evening meal. Transport is being organised for those wishing to attend with number limited to 48. Anyone with mobility issues please speak to a member of SVP prior to the event. A donation of £5 per person would be greatly appreciated.

Anyone interested in attending should call the SVP number (**07860 455 549**) and leave their name and contact number, or speak to an SVP representative.

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION

A new committee to promote Eucharistic Adoration in our diocese is being set up. They are looking for people who would be interested in supporting their work through promotion, speaking in parishes, organisation or prayer. If you're interested in getting involved please speak to Fr Damian for more information.

CAUSEWAY COAST PEACE GROUP

The group invite you to the first in their 25th Anniversary series of meetings for 2026-27 on **Tuesday 8th September** at **10am** in **Ballintoy Parish Church Hall**. The speaker will be Shona McCarthy who is speaking on *Peace Through a Creative Lens*. A warm welcome will be extended to all who come along.

PARISH OF BALLYMONEY
& DERRYKEIGHAN

Diocese of Down & Connor
Causeway Family of Parishes

Contact Details

Very Rev. Damian McCaughan PP VF

81 Castle Street
BALLYMONEY
Co. Antrim
BT53 6JT

Tel: 028 2766 2003

Email: ballymoney@downandconnor.org

Website: www.ballymoneyparish.com

Facebook: [@ballymoneycatholic](https://www.facebook.com/ballymoneycatholic)

HYMNS FOR MASS

Soul of my Saviour sanctify my breast,
Body of Christ, be thou my saving guest,
Blood of my Saviour, bathe me in thy tide,
wash me with water flowing from thy side.

Strength and protection may thy passion be,
O blessed Jesus, hear and answer me;
deep in thy wounds, Lord, hide and shelter me,
so shall I never, never part from thee.

O Lord, my God,
when I, in awesome wonder
Consider all
the worlds Thy hands have made
I see the stars,
I hear the rolling thunder
Thy power throughout
the universe displayed

Then sings my soul,
my Saviour God to Thee,
How great Thou art, how great Thou art.
Then sings my soul,
my Saviour God to Thee,
How great Thou art, how great Thou art.

OLD & NEW@No.5

There's lots of new stock again this week from an old vintage sewing machine to a large pair of two handled vases, nice pairs of candlesticks, jug and basin sets, and much more.

Visit us at 5 Gate End, Ballymoney, open **Wednesday to Saturday, 10am - 4.30pm**. To keep in touch with our offers and to see pictures of our stock don't forget our Facebook page **@oldandnewatno5**

MEN'S RETREAT

A Catholic men's retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on **Saturday 19th September**, from **9am** to **1pm**. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on **07967 620435** or email **sean@catholicminute.co.uk**

CAUSEWAY PARISHES PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK

There will be a pilgrimage to Knock Shrine for our Causeway Family of Parishes on **Saturday 3rd October** led by **Fr Kevin McGuckien**. The bus will make pickups from Portrush, Portstewart, Coleraine and Ballymoney leaving at approximately 7am and returning around 10.30pm. The cost is **£35 for adults** and **£10 for children**. You can book a place by phoning **07724 092063**.

OTHER TRIPS TO KNOCK

The Legion of Mary Annual Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine will take place on **Sunday 27th September**. A coach will leave Dunloy Parish Centre at 7am, returning by 9.30pm. Information/booking: **07471537051**

There will be another trip to Knock on **Saturday 3rd October**. A bus will be leaving St Patrick's Church Loughguile at 6am. Contact Patricia Campbell on **02827641120** or **07871626940**.

Mass Timings for the weekdays and weekends (17th August onwards)

Mass Times

Monday - 7pm St Nicholas

Tuesday - 10am St Nicholas

Thursday - 7pm Our Lady of Lourdes

Friday - 10am Our Lady of Lourdes

Sunday - 9.30 Our Lady of Lourdes

- 11.30 St Nicholas

Confessions

Monday - 6.15 to 6.50 - St Nicholas

Thursday - 6.15 to 6.50 - Our Lady of Lourdes

Sunday - 9am to 9.20am - Our Lady of Lourdes

Sunday - 11am to 11.20am - St Nicholas



Holy Family Parish

A praying, caring community, centred in Christ

Holy Family Parish is a member of a Family of Parishes, comprising the parishes of St Patrick’s, Holy Family and St Gerard’s.

MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

Holy Family Church: 6pm Vigil & 10.30am
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: 9am & 12noon

WEEKDAYS

Holy Family Church: 9.15am Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: 10.00am Thursday, Friday & Saturday

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION

Holy Family Church: Saturday 5.15pm-5.45pm
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: Saturday after 10am Mass

BAPTISMS

(Prior booking via Parish Office)

Holy Family Church: Saturdays at 4pm
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: Sundays at 1pm

DEVOTIONS

Eucharistic Adoration: Daily 10am-10pm (St Thérèse)
Pilgrim Prayer: Tuesday 8pm on the Parish Facebook page
Novena to Our Mother of Perpetual Help: Wed 9:15am Mass
First Saturday: 10am (Holy Family)
Taizé Prayer: last Friday of the month 8-9pm (Holy Family)

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Tue 08: The Birthday of the Blessed Virgin Mary
Wed 09: St Ciaran of Clonmacnoise
Sat 12: St Ailbe of Munster

“The Birthday of Our Lady – the hope of the entire world and the dawn of salvation.” Pope St Paul VI



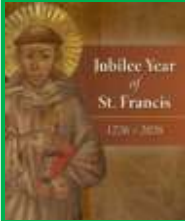
CONTACT INFORMATION

Parish Clergy: Very Rev. Michael Spence PP,
Rev. John O’Lavery CC & Rev. Deacon Brendan Dowd

Parish Telephone (Office hours): 90743119
Office hours: Mon-Thu 9.30am-2.30pm, Fri 9.30am-1.30pm
Address: 226-228 Limestone Road, Belfast BT15 3AP

Emergency Sick Calls only (24hrs): 07928968773
Society of St Vincent de Paul (Helpline): 028 90351561

Email: holyfamily@downandconnor.org
Website & Webcam: www.holy-familyparish.com



23RD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

6TH SEPTEMBER 2026
Readings: A (II) Psalter: Week III



The Season of Creation is celebrated each year from September 1 (the World Day of Prayer for Creation) to October 4 (the feast of St. Francis of Assisi).

The Biblical text for this year is drawn from Ezekiel 47: 1- 12, which portrays God’s life-giving water flowing from the temple of God. The river grows deeper and deeper restoring barren land, reviving waters, and sustaining flourishing eco-systems. The vision invites human responsibility: recognising ecological damage, embracing interconnectedness, we are called to immerse ourselves in the water, and actively safeguarding and working for the renewal of creation so that environmental healing and human well-being may flourish together. For more information visit www.seasonofcreation.org or www.laudatosimovement.org

St Colmcille's

Laudato Si' Group

in association with **trócaire**

invite you to join us for

Heroes for Humanity

A series of workshops exploring the principles of Catholic Social Teaching, through the lives of four remarkable individuals.

Wednesday
9 September 2026
Saint Oscar Romero

Wednesday
16 September 2026
Sister Dorothy Stang

Wednesday
23 September 2026
Dorothy Day

Wednesday
30 September 2026
Martin Luther King Jr

Each event will be in St Colmcille's Parish Hall, 191a Upper Newtownards Road, Belfast, BT4 3JB

Beginning at 7.15 pm

Ending with a supper around 8.45 pm

All are welcome! ♥

6PM MASS ON SUNDAY, 6TH SEPT. IN ST. PATRICK’S CHURCH, DONEGALL STREET. Will celebrate the beginning of the Season of Creation, a time when Christians world-wide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme “Living Water”. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions.

JUBILEE YEAR OF SAINT FRANCIS

Remember Reverence: “Praised be you, my Lord, through Sister Moon and the stars; in heaven you formed them clear and precious and beautiful.” (St Francis of Assisi)

A Prayer Resource

30 DAYS WITH ST FRANCIS OF ASSISI. To mark this anniversary year, and to prepare for the feast day of St Francis’ on 04th October, this booklet is available from the parish office, price £3. Using the words of St Francis himself, it offers Scripture and short prayers. This simple resource can help us to reflect on the wisdom of St Francis, for today.

PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY OFFERING. The weekly collection on Sunday 30th August came to £2,307.50. Thank you for your continued generosity and support. For information on standing order and contactless methods of donation, please contact the parish office.

PARISH 100 CLUB. Week 17 winners: Marie-Thérèse Morris, Tara Cullinan, Adelaide Moreland & Brenda Killough (Promoter). Congratulations to all the winners.

WEEKDAYS MONDAY 14TH, TUESDAY 15TH & WEDNESDAY 16TH SEPTEMBER: There will be a Gathering for the Priests of Down & Connor in Dromantine for these days. As a result, there will be **No** 9.15am Mass on these mornings. However, Deacon Brendan will be leading a Eucharistic Adoration Prayer Service at 9.15am on each morning. The normal Mass schedule will resume on Thursday 17th September. Apologies for the inconvenience.

NEW LODGE GROTTTO 50TH ANNIVERSARY CELEBRATIONS. Monday 7th September. Rosary at the Grotto at 6.30pm, followed by Mass at 7pm. All welcome.

PUBLIC MEETING ON BUILDING A PRO-LIFE IRELAND. In the Lansdowne Hotel on Thursday 10th September at 7.30pm. Featuring key speakers including Aontú Party Leader Peadar Kirby TD, and Bernadette Smyth of Precious Life.

NEWINGTON CREDIT UNION SEEKS VOLUNTEERS, for the Board of Directors & Supervisory Committee. No previous experience is required. Full training and support will be provided. Contact 028 9035 1040 or E: info@newingtoncreditunion.co.uk.

DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG. 19th September. Leaving St Paul’s at 6.30am, returning to St Paul’s at 7.30pm. Retreat £45, bus separate. T: 02890325034 (St Paul’s).

BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE. A Year of Ignatian Prayer. Starts 26th September; Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available. Registration required. *The Chosen – Season 2.* Weekly screenings on Fridays at 10.45am, which started 4th September. And job vacancy for *Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator.* For all, visit belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk.

THE OLD PAROCHIAL HOUSE AT ST THÉRÈSE CHURCH. Sincere thanks to all those who organised and supported Dom Polski, to make last Sunday’s garden party such a great success.

EXCITING PARISH EVENT COMING UP.

Please save the date.

Sunday 4th October at 7pm

Details to follow.

REST IN PEACE

Recently Deceased: Jordan Flannery

Month’s Mind: Jim O’Connor

Anniversaries: James Richard Hann, Anne Rogan, David Parker (20th), Patricia O’Hare, Barney Deery, Maureen McGrath, Joe Magee (1st), Mary Snow, Bridie May, Joanne Morgan, William Madden (1st), Eoin Loughran, Bernadette Gillen, John & Sally Murphy, Frank McGoldrick, Mary Collins

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord!

For more information and resources:
www.holy-familyparish.com

MASS INTENTIONS

Sat 5 (6pm):	For the People of the Parish
Sun 6 (9am):	Priest’s Intention
Sun 6 (10.30am):	Mary Snow & Bridie May
Sun 6 (12 Noon):	Joanne Morgan
Mon 7:	William Madden (1 st)
Tue 8:	Bernadette Gillen
Wed 9:	Jim O’Connor MM
Thu 10:	John & Sally Murphy
Fri 11:	Priest’s Intention
Sat 12 (10am):	Geraldine Hart

Parish of Blaris

Sunday 6th September 2026
The Twenty Third Sunday in Ordinary Time

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH

Masses Monday – Friday 10.00am

Saturday Vigil: 6.30pm

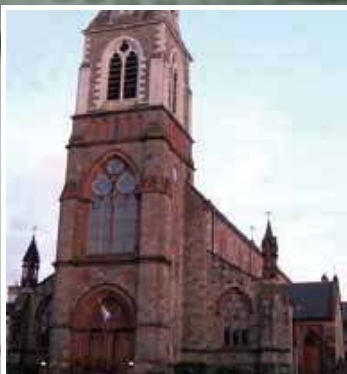
Sunday: 10.00am & 12 noon

LIVE WEBSTREAMING OF ALL MASSES

Please note many parishes in the Diocese have webcams installed which provide live coverage of various Masses taking place daily throughout the Diocese. These can be accessed by visiting www.downandconnor.org Links to Parish Webcams. Live Church webcam links: CHURCH SERVICES. TV & MCN MEDIA CHURCH WEBCAMS

*'For where two or three meet in my name,
I shall be there with them.'*

Matthew 18:20



Fr. Dermot McCaughan, PP: 028 9266 2341
Fr. Eamon Magorrian, CC: 028 9266 2348

Parish Office Opening Hours:
Monday-Friday 10.30am-4.00pm.
Closed 1.00pm-2.00pm.

Parish Office: 028 9266 0206 Fax: 028 9266 5690
Email: lisburn@downandconnor.org
Pastoral Centre: 028 9260 7110
www.parishoflisburn.org

INTRODUCTORY RITES

Congregation stands

**Entrance Hymn or
Entrance Antiphon**

PPs 118: 137, 124

All: You are just, O Lord,
and your judgement is right;
treat your servant in accord with your
merciful love.

GREETING

Priest: In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and
of the Holy Spirit.

All: Amen

Priest: Grace to you and peace from God our Father and
the Lord Jesus Christ.

All: And with your spirit.

PENITENTIAL ACT

Priest: Brothers and sisters, let us acknowledge our sins,
and so prepare ourselves to celebrate the sacred
mysteries.

All: I confess to almighty God
and to you, my brothers and sisters,
that I have greatly sinned,
in my thoughts and in my words, in what I
have done and in what I have failed to do,

Striking your breast as you say:

through my fault, through my fault,
through my most grievous fault;
therefore I ask blessed Mary ever-Virgin,
all the Angels and Saints,
and you, my brothers and sisters,
to pray for me to the Lord our God.

Priest: May almighty God have mercy on us,
forgive us our sins,
and bring us to everlasting life.

All: Amen

Lord, have mercy.
Christ, have mercy.
Lord, have mercy.

Lord, have mercy.
Christ, have mercy.
Lord, have mercy.

GLORIA

All: Glory to God in the highest,
and on earth peace to people of good will.

We praise you, we bless you,
we adore you, we glorify you,
we give you thanks for your great glory,
Lord God, heavenly King,
O God, almighty Father.

Lord Jesus Christ, Only Begotten Son,
Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father,
you take away the sins of the world,
have mercy on us;
you take away the sins of the world,
receive our prayer;
you are seated at the right hand of the Father,
have mercy on us.

For you alone are the Holy One, you alone are the
Lord, you alone are the Most High,
Jesus Christ, with the Holy Spirit, in the glory of
God the Father. Amen.

THE COLLECT

Priest: Let us pray.

Pause for silent prayer

Priest: O God, by whom we are redeemed and receive
adoption, look graciously upon your beloved sons
and daughters, that those who believe in Christ
may receive true freedom
and an everlasting inheritance.
Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son,
who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the
Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever.

All: Amen.

THE LITURGY OF THE WORD

Congregation Sits

FIRST READING

A reading from the prophet Ezekiel

33:7-9

The word of the Lord was addressed to me as follows, 'Son
of man, I have appointed you as sentry to the House of
Israel. When you hear a word from my mouth, warn them
in my name. If I say to a wicked man: Wicked wretch, you
are to die, and you do not speak to warn the wicked man to
renounce his ways, then he shall die for his sin, but I will
hold you responsible for his death. If, however, you do
warn a wicked man to renounce his ways and repent, and
he does not repent, then he shall die for his sin, but you
yourself will have saved your life.'

All: The word of the Lord
Thanks be to God.

RESPONSORIAL PSALM

Ps 94:1-2. 6-9. R v.8

(R) O that today you would listen to his voice!
Harden not your hearts.

1. Come, ring out our joy to the Lord;
hail the rock who saves us.
Let us come before him, giving thanks,
with songs let us hail the Lord. **(R)**

2. Come in; let us bow and bend low;
let us kneel before the God who made us
for he is our God and we
the people who belong to his pasture,
the flock that is led by his hand. **(R)**

3. O that today you would listen to his voice!
'Harden not your hearts as at Meribah,
as on that day at Massah in the desert,
when your fathers put me to the test;
when they tried me, though they saw my work. **(R)**

SECOND READING

A reading from the letter of St Paul to the Romans

13.8-10

Avoid getting into debt, except the debt of mutual love. If
you love your fellow men you have carried out your
obligations. All the commandments: You shall not commit
adultery, you shall not kill, you shall not steal, you shall not
covet, and so on, are summed up in this single command:
You must love your neighbour as yourself. Love is the one
thing that cannot hurt your neighbour; that is why it is the
answer to every one of the commandments.

All: The word of the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Congregation stands

ACCLAMATION

Jn 17:17

All: Alleluia, alleluia!
Your word is truth, O Lord,
consecrate us in the truth.
Alleluia!

GOSPEL

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: A reading from the holy
Gospel according to Matthew

18:15-20

All: **Glory to you, O Lord.**

Jesus said to his disciples: 'If your brother does something wrong, go and have it out with him alone, between your two selves. If he listens to you, you have won back your brother. If he does not listen, take one or two others along with you: the evidence of two or three witnesses is required to sustain any charge. But if he refuses to listen to these, report it to the community: and if he refuses to listen to the community, treat him like a pagan or a tax collector.

'I tell you solemnly, whatever you bind on earth shall be considered bound in heaven; whatever you loose on earth shall be considered loosed in heaven.

'I tell you solemnly once again, if two of you on earth agree to ask anything at all, it will be granted to you by my Father in heaven. For where two or three meet in my name, I shall be there with them.'

The Gospel of the Lord.

All: **Praise to you Lord Jesus Christ.**

Congregation sits

HOMILY

Congregation stand

THE CREED

All: **I believe in one God,
the Father almighty,
maker of heaven and earth,
of all things visible and invisible.**

**I believe in one Lord Jesus Christ,
the Only Begotten Son of God,
born of the Father before all ages.
God from God, Light from Light,
true God from true God,
begotten, not made, consubstantial with the
Father; through him all things were made
For us men and for our salvation
he came down from heaven,**

(bow your head up to the words 'and became man')

**and by the Holy Spirit was incarnate of the Virgin
Mary, and became man.**

**For our sake he was crucified under Pontius
Pilate, he suffered death and was buried,
and rose again on the third day
in accordance with the Scriptures.
He ascended into heaven
and is seated at the right hand of the Father.**

**He will come again in glory
to judge the living and the dead**

and his kingdom will have no end.

**I believe in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the giver of
life, who proceeds from the Father and the Son,
who with the Father and the Son is adored and
glorified, who has spoken through the prophets.**

**I believe in one, holy, catholic and apostolic
Church. I confess one Baptism for the forgiveness
of sins and I look forward to the resurrection of
the dead and the life of the world to come. Amen.**

PRAYER OF THE FAITHFUL

Congregation sits

THE LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST

Offertory Procession

*The gifts of bread and wine which will become the Lord's body
and blood are brought to the altar.*

The celebrant raises the host on the paten saying:

Priest: Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation,
for through your goodness we have received
the bread we offer you:
fruit of the earth and work of human hands,
it will become for us the bread of life.

All: **Blessed be God for ever.**

*The celebrant pours wine and a little water into the
chalice, saying quietly:*

Priest: By the mystery of this water and wine
may we come to share in the divinity of Christ
who humbled himself to share in our humanity.

*The celebrant then raises the chalice above the
altar and says:*

Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation,
for through your goodness we have received
the wine we offer you:
fruit of the vine and work of human hands,
it will become our spiritual drink.

All: **Blessed be God for ever.**

Bowing, the celebrant says quietly:

Priest: With humble spirit and contrite heart
may we be accepted by you, O Lord,
and may our sacrifice in your sight this day
be pleasing to you, Lord God.

Then the celebrant washes his hands, saying quietly:

Wash me, O Lord, from my iniquity
and cleanse me from my sin.

Pray, brothers and sisters, that my sacrifice and
yours may be acceptable to God,
the almighty Father.

All: **May the Lord accept the sacrifice at your hands
for the praise and glory of his name, for our
good and the good of all his holy Church.**

PRAYER OVER THE OFFERINGS

Priest: O God, who give us the gift of true prayer and of peace, graciously grant that through this offering, we may do fitting homage to your divine majesty and, by partaking of the sacred mystery, we may be faithfully united in mind and heart. Through Christ our Lord.

All: **Amen**

Congregation stands

EUCCHARISTIC PRAYER III

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: Lift up your hearts.

All: **We lift them up to the Lord.**

Priest: Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.

All: **It is right and just.**

PREFACE (VI of Ordinary Time)

Priest: It is truly right and just, our duty and our salvation, always and everywhere to give you thanks, Lord, holy Father, almighty and eternal God.

For in you we live and move and have our being, and while in this body we not only experience the daily effects of your care, but even now possess the pledge of life eternal.

For, having received the first fruits of the Spirit, through whom you raised up Jesus from the dead, we hope for an everlasting share in the Paschal Mystery.

And so, with all the Angels, we praise you, as in joyful celebration we acclaim:

ACCLAMATION

All: **Holy, Holy, Holy Lord God of hosts.
Heaven and earth are full of your glory.
Hosanna in the highest.
Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord.
Hosanna in the highest.**

Priest: You are indeed Holy, O Lord, and all you have created rightly gives you praise, for through your Son our Lord Jesus Christ, by the power and working of the Holy Spirit, you give life to all things and make them holy, and you never cease to gather a people to yourself, so that from the rising of the sun to its setting a pure sacrifice may be offered to your name.

Therefore, O Lord, we humbly implore you: by the same Spirit graciously make holy these gifts we have brought to you for consecration, that they may become the Body and + Blood of your Son our Lord Jesus Christ, at whose command we celebrate these mysteries.

For on the night he was betrayed he himself took bread, and, giving you thanks, he said the blessing, broke the bread and gave it to his disciples, saying:

TAKE THIS, ALL OF YOU, AND EAT OF IT,
FOR THIS IS MY BODY
WHICH WILL BE GIVEN UP FOR YOU.

In a similar way, when supper was ended, he took the chalice and, giving you thanks, he said the blessing, and gave the chalice to his disciples, saying:

TAKE THIS, ALL OF YOU, AND DRINK FROM IT,
FOR THIS IS THE CHALICE OF MY BLOOD,
THE BLOOD OF THE NEW AND ETERNAL
COVENANT, WHICH WILL BE POURED OUT FOR
YOU AND FOR MANY FOR THE FORGIVENESS
OF SINS.

DO THIS IN MEMORY OF ME.

Priest: The mystery of faith.

All: **Save us, Saviour of the world,
for by your Cross and Resurrection
you have set us free.**

Priest: Therefore, O Lord, as we celebrate the memorial of the saving Passion of your Son, his wondrous Resurrection and Ascension into heaven, and as we look forward to his second coming, we offer you in thanksgiving this holy and living sacrifice.

Look, we pray, upon the oblation of your Church and, recognising the sacrificial Victim by whose death you willed to reconcile us to yourself, grant that we, who are nourished by the Body and Blood of your Son and filled with his Holy Spirit, may become one body, one spirit in Christ.

May he make of us an eternal offering to you, so that we may obtain an inheritance with your elect, especially with the most Blessed Virgin Mary, Mother of God, with blessed Joseph, her spouse, with your blessed Apostles and glorious Martyrs with Saint Patrick and with all the Saints, on whose constant intercession in your presence we rely for unfailing help.

May this Sacrifice of our reconciliation, we pray, O Lord, advance the peace and salvation of all the world. Be pleased to confirm in faith and charity your pilgrim Church on earth, with your servant Leo our Pope and **N** our Bishop, the Order of Bishops, all the clergy, and the entire people you have gained for your own.

Listen graciously to the prayers of this family, whom you have summoned before you: in your compassion, O merciful Father, gather to yourself all your children scattered throughout the world. To our departed brothers and sisters and to all who were pleasing to you at their passing from this life, give kind admittance to your kingdom. There we hope to enjoy for ever the fullness of your glory through Christ our Lord, through whom you bestow on the world all that is good.

Priest: Through him, and with him, and in him, O God, almighty Father, in the unity of the Holy Spirit,

All: all glory and honour is yours,
for ever and ever.
Amen.

Congregation stands

THE COMMUNION RITE

Priest: At the Saviour's command
and formed by divine teaching,
we dare to say:

All: **Our Father, who art in heaven,
hallowed be thy name;
thy kingdom come,
thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our trespasses,
as we forgive those who trespass against us;
and lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.**

Priest: Deliver us, Lord, we pray, from every evil,
graciously grant peace in our days,
that, by the help of your mercy,
we may be always free from sin
and safe from all distress,
as we await the blessed hope
and the coming of our Saviour, Jesus Christ.

All: **For the kingdom, the power and the glory
are yours now and for ever.**

Priest: Lord Jesus Christ, who said to your Apostles:
Peace I leave you, my peace I give you,
look not on our sins, but on the faith of your Church,
and graciously grant her peace and unity
in accordance with your will.
Who live and reign for ever and ever.

All: **Amen.**

Priest: The peace of the Lord be with you always.
All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: May this mingling of the Body and Blood of our Lord
Jesus Christ bring eternal life to us who receive it.

All: **Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, have mercy on us.
Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, have mercy on us.
Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, grant us peace.**

Congregation kneels

The celebrant says quietly:

Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God,
who, by the will of the Father
and the work of the Holy Spirit,
through your Death gave life to the world,
free me by this, your most holy Body and Blood,
from all my sins and from every evil;
keep me always faithful to your commandments,
and never let me be parted from you.

INVITATION TO HOLY COMMUNION

Priest: Behold the Lamb of God,
behold him who takes away the sins of the world.
Blessed are those called to the supper of the Lamb.

All: **Lord, I am not worthy
that you should enter under my roof,
but only say the word
and my soul shall be healed.**

Priest: May the Body of Christ
keep me safe for eternal life.

Priest: May the Blood of Christ
keep me safe for eternal life.

COMMUNION ANTIPHON

Cf. Ps 41:2-3

All: **Like the deer that yearns for running streams,
so my soul is yearning for you, my God;
my soul is thirsting for God, the living God.**

Purifying the chalice the celebrant says quietly:

What has passed our lips as food, O Lord,
may we possess in purity of heart,
that what has been given to us in time
may be our healing for eternity.

PRAYER AFTER COMMUNION

Congregation kneels

Priest: Let us pray.
Grant that your faithful, O Lord,
whom you nourish and endow with life
through the food of your Word and heavenly
Sacrament, may so benefit from your beloved Son's
great gifts that we may merit an eternal share in his
life. Who lives and reigns for ever and ever.

All: **Amen**

THE CONCLUDING RITES

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: May the peace of God,
which surpasses all understanding,
keep your hearts and minds
in the knowledge and love of God,
and of his Son, our Lord Jesus Christ.

All: **Amen**

Priest: And may the blessing of almighty God,
the Father, and the Son, + and the Holy Spirit,
come down on you and remain with you for ever.

All: **Amen**

Then the celebrant, with hands joined and facing the people, says:

Priest: Go in peace.

All: **Thanks be to God.**

Imprimatur – nihil obstat: + Most Rev. Alan McGuckian, SJ, Bishop of Down and Connor. Excerpts from the English translation of The Roman Missal © 2010, International Committee on English in the Liturgy Corporation. All rights reserved. Jerusalem Bible version of the scriptures copyright: Darton, Longman & Todd Ltd and Doubleday & Co. Inc. Responsorial Psalms are copyright The Grail and/or Geoffrey Chapman Ltd. Created and published by Tara Lees, 1 Lille Park, Belfast, BT10 0LR. T: 02890302817. E: tarabooklet@gmail.com.



We remember our beloved dead:

RECENTLY DECEASED: Mona Mulholland: Ted Rooney.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY: Cathy McMullan

ANNIVERSARIES: Pat Loughran: Matthew McKibben: Mary Wilson: Gerald (Gerry) McGrath:
Fr Denis Newberry: Ernie Gordon: Elizabeth Gallagher: Michael McGann: Gerald & Sheila Kelly:
Tommy Catney: Claire Fox: Magdalene Lagan.

THIS WEEK'S CALENDAR

Tuesday 8th September – The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Wednesday 9th September – St Ciaran, Abbot

Saturday 12 September – The Holy Name of Mary

INDIAN CATHOLIC COMMUNITY

Mass in Syro-Malabar Rite will be celebrated in St. Patrick's Church at 3pm this afternoon, 6th September.



CHILDREN'S LITURGY will commence again on Sunday 13th September 2026 during 10am Mass. This group welcomes all children from 4-11 years of age (Primary 1 to Primary 7). Please note that you must register your child/children **BEFORE** this date. If you would like your child to be registered, there will be a registration session on **Sunday 6th September before and after 10am Mass in the Pastoral Centre**. If a child has not been registered they cannot attend. If you already registered your child last year, you do not need to re-register. Additionally, if you would like to be part of our Children's Liturgy Team of Volunteers, please contact the Parish Office. We look forward to welcoming the children back in September.

**New Suzuki Method baby/
toddler class**
Unique in Ireland
Suitable from birth- age 3
Friday 9:30 Parish Centre



"Babies who participated in the interactive music classes (Suzuki Baby/Toddler classes) showed earlier sensitivity to the pitch structure in music. The non-musical differences between the two groups of babies were even more surprising, say researchers. Babies from the interactive classes showed better early communication skills, they smiled more, were easier to soothe, and showed less distress with unfamiliar things."

Contact Keri
07709495255
Suzuki Method NI

PIC • COLLAGE

SCRIPTURE GROUP resumes after our summer break on Tuesday 8th September .

We meet in the Parish Pastoral Centre every Tuesday 7:30 - 8:30 to study, discuss and reflect on the Mass readings for the following weekend.

A YEAR OF IGNATIAN PRAYER 2026-2027 – BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE

There are a few places remaining on our immersive programme in **Ignatian Spirituality**, which returns on Saturday 26th September; offering ten in person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the BJC and seven online **Integrative Practice Pause Points** to support prayer, discernment and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: **£200–£280**. Bursaries available.

For dates and registration, please visit: <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/a-year-of-ignatian-prayer-2026-2027/>

THE CHOSEN – SEASON 2 AT THE BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE

Weekly screenings of The Chosen: Season 2 will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required. Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.

Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk

DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG

Saturday 19th September

Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake.

Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs.

BULLETIN NOTICES AND ANNIVERSARIES

Bulletin Notices should be with the Parish Office by 12 noon on Monday to be included in the weekend bulletin.

Please note all emails to Parish Office should be addressed to –
lisburn@downandconnor.org

**DOWN AND CONNOR DIOCESAN TRUST
BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE**

Vacancy "Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator"

The Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator will support the Director of the Belfast Jesuit Centre & Chaplain to the Ulster University, Belfast. Full details relating to the vacancy can be found on the Diocesan website at www.downandconnor.org clicking on the tab: Job Vacancies, also of the Community NI website: belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk and nijob.com

THINKING ABOUT BECOMING CATHOLIC OR WANT TO DEEPEN YOUR UNDERSTANDING OF THE FAITH?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2025–2026 programme begins on Wednesday 1st October and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away. To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20).

The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

CALLED & GIFTED - DISCOVER YOUR SPIRITUAL GIFTS

Have you ever wondered how God might be working in your life, or what gifts He has given you to use for others? Called and Gifted is a guided process to help you discern the Spiritual gifts you received at your Baptism, and how God is calling you to use them.

We invite you to journey with others to discover:

- Who God is calling you to be: How the Holy Spirit is at work in your life
- The unique gifts you have been given to share with others.

Where?

- 120 Cliftonville Road, Belfast **When?** Saturday 26 Sept, 9.30am-4pm: Wednesday 21st Oct, 7pm-9pm: Wednesday 4th Nov, 7pm-9pm: Wednesday 18th Nov, 7pm-9pm: Saturday 5th Dec, 9.30am-4pm
- Cost: £50 per person

Attendance on all training dates is required. This training involves the use of online resources so requires access to a laptop, tablet or smartphone and a basic level of digital skills. **Please click on the link to register to attend by 11 Sept 2026.** <https://forms.cloud.microsoft/e/EbEJb01BDs> If you require further information, please contact us at: email: pathwaystothefuture@downandconnor.org Tel: (028) 9069 0920.



COFFEE MORNING

In aid of the Anthony Nolan Appeal on Sunday 13th September 10.30am – 1.30pm. Everyone welcome.

ST PATRICK'S GAC

Senior Ladies started off their Championship with an emphatic win. Next up for them is the short trip to Davitt Park to take on Davitts this evening (Sun 6th September) with throw in at 6pm.

Last weekend we had the wonderful "Festival of Football" which saw around 400 children from 15 different clubs take part in an underage tournament. Congratulations to U10.5 St Patrick's team who won the Cup.

Commiserations to the U8.5 St Patrick's team who were runners up.

Congratulations are also due to the U16 girls team who recently won the league.

This was a fantastic achievement for the girls and management team - Well done.

*Lord, may everything we do this day
begin with your blessing and continue with your help.
May everything we say this day begin with your love
and continue with your grace.
May everything we plan this day begin with your inspiration
and continue with your peace.
So that throughout our lives all that we begin in you may be happily ended,
all that we fail to do may by you be mercifully mended,
and all that we seek though you may by you be lovingly attended. Amen.
Prayer Trust.*

49 Bridge Street
Lisburn
92 676 733



THE EYE CLINIC
Hillsborough - Lisburn

5 Ballynahinch st
Hillsborough
92 688 881

- Doctor Colum Rooney
- Specialising in early glaucoma detection
- Red eye clinic for emergency appts
- Punctal plugs for dry eye conditions
- Private and NHS welcome

FREE glasses for Kids

Peter McEvoy
Financial Guidance

Shocked by your Insurance
Renewal this year?

Annual renewal prices are
up by as much as 150%

You don't have to stay with
your current Company.

I'll help you find a
better deal!!!!

Call Peter at
07803178868

FUNERAL
RONNIE THOMPSON
DIRECTOR

Service With Dignity & Respect

**Funeral Plans
&
Monumental**

T: 028 9260 7367
20 Ballinderry Road, Lisburn

**Ear Wax
Removal**

Was £75 → Now £55

**Hearing Aids
Hearing Tests**

Blueberry
Simply better hearing

Newry, Banbridge, Lurgan
& Belfast (coming soon)
028 3025 0438

**Call to
Appear
Here!**

HEALTH ONE GROUP
HEALTHCARE AGENCY

**Health One
Homecare**

What we Offer:
Day Visits & Daytime Care
Night Sits & Overnight Care
Personal Care
Practical Help at Home
Companionship & Social Support
Specialised Care

Call us for more info 028 9622 7356 (Ext 3)

"Your Care, Your Home, Your Way"

ESTD. 1972
Drayne's
DAIRY FARM CO. ANTRIM

Drayne's Farm
1 Glenavy Road, Lisburn
BT28 3JP

028 9266 2203
sales@draynesfarm.co.uk

f @ in

www.draynesfarm.co.uk

STANLEY GORDON fuels

HEATING OIL AT COMPETITIVE PRICES
CALL NOW TO PLACE YOUR ORDER!

Online
saving plan
now
available



Lisburn & Belfast
Tel: 028 9267 8649

bw
bowman windows

**Up to
30% OFF**

Our Big Summer Sale
SALE IS NOW ON!

"A" Rated Windows
PVC Sliding Sash Windows
PVC and Composite Doors
Fascia, Soffit & Guttering
PVC Dry Verge Edging to Gables
Aluminium Patio & Bi Fold Doors
Manual & Automatic Garage Doors

Find us on
f @

T: 028 4066 2000
E: info@bowman-windows.co.uk
W: www.bowmanwindowsni.co.uk

55

Showroom and Sales Office 50a Newry Road, Banbridge BT22 3HA
Showroom opening hours: Mon-Thu 9.00am-5.30pm • Fri 9.30am-1.30pm • Saturday: Closed

TERRA
CONCRETE IMPRINTS LTD.

- Concrete Sealers
- Brick Pavers Sealers
- Tarmac Sealers
- Concrete Colour Hardeners
- Concrete Imprinting Products & Materials

Free Quotations for Imprinted
Concrete Supplier of all
necessary materials.

For more information
contact Damien
077438 74074

+

Pond Park Pharmacy

A & A Rooney

Monday - Friday 9.00am - 5.30pm
Saturday 9.00am - 5.00pm
Sunday 12.30pm - 5.00pm

Telephone / Fax - 9262 9925
Prescription Collection Service Available

**MOURNE OFFICE
SUPPLIES
PRINT &
DESIGN**

- Memory Cards
- Mass Booklets
- Wedding Invitations
- All printing needs

Call Bronagh:
028 4175 3646

EASTWOOD MOTORS



Subaru Forester

0% APR
50% deposit
50% in 2 years*

£1,000 OFF**
when you trade in
and trade up.

3 YEARS
servicing for just
£399**

GYPSY
The Musical

9th-12th September 2026
Island Hall, Lisburn

www.laganvalleyisland.co.uk
Box Office: 02892 447744
Scan the QR code to book



www.laganvalleyisland.co.uk

**SEYMOUR
DUGAN
INTERIORS**

Lisburn's carpet,
furniture, rug and
flooring superstore!

See more
bargains at
Seymour Dugan's.

Mon-Sat: 9am to 5.30pm
Late Night Thursday to 8pm
(Furniture & Rugs Only)

42-56 Chapel Hill, Lisburn
Tel: 028 92 66 3587

KENNY MCKINSTRY



View our wide range of
equipment including
chainsaws,
leaf blowers,
log splitters etc...

AUTUMN
IS HERE SO
GET YOUR
GARDEN
READY!

5 year warranty with any Echo product
Monday - Friday 8.30am - 5.30pm
Saturday 9am - 1pm

1 White Row, Ballydown, Banbridge
028 4066 2252

Bobby Morrison

- Funeral Directors
- Memorial Masons

028 92 674292 028 92 660262

38 - 42 Hillsborough Road, Lisburn
E: info@bobbymorrison.co.uk
W: www.bobbymorrison.co.uk

Support your local
Parish Booklet

Small, Medium &
Large ads available.

Call
07595 221 497
to appear here.

This could be you!



The Loughshore Parishes



St Mary's, Greencastle; St Mary, Star of the Sea, Whitehouse;
St James', Whiteabbey & St Colman's, Greenisland



6 September 2026

23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time

MASS TIMES & SERVICES

SATURDAY VIGIL

5.00pm – Star of the Sea, Whitehouse

6.30pm – St Mary's, Greencastle

SUNDAY MASS:

9.30am – St Colman's, Greenisland

11.00am – St James', Whiteabbey

WEEKDAY MASSES:

Star of the Sea, Whitehouse: Tuesday 7.00pm

St Mary's, Greencastle: Wednesday 9.30am

St Colman's: Thursday 10.00am

St James': Friday 10.00am

MORNING PRAYER & COMMUNION SERVICE

St Colman's: Monday 10.00am

ST PEREGRINE'S NOVENA:

First Monday of the month at 7.00pm in St Mary's, Greencastle

NOVENA TO MOTHER OF PERPETUAL SUCCOUR:

Every Tuesday at 7.00pm in Star of the Sea, Whitehouse

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION:

Every Wednesday in St Mary's, Greencastle 10am – 1pm

DIVINE MERCY CHAPLET:

After 10.00am Mass on Friday in St James'

DIVINE MERCY EVENING – Rosary, preaching, healing prayers and Eucharistic Adoration on the second Friday of the month 7.00pm – 9.30pm St James' Church.

LEGION OF MARY

The Legion of Mary is a lay association of pious, Marian Catholics, who specialise in both prayer and work. They meet at 7pm every Friday in St. Mary's Church, Greencastle.

BAPTISMS: Baptisms are taking place on Saturdays in St James', Whiteabbey. Please contact the parish office for further information.

Parish Priest:

Fr. David Delargy

Parish Office:

824 Shore Road Newtownabbey BT36 7DG

Tel: 0289037 0845

(open Mon – Fri 9.00am – 1.00pm)

E-mail: loughshore@downandconnor.org

website: www.loughshoreparishes.org

Links to webcam via parish website or www.churchmedia.tv

The Loughshore Parishes is a member of a Family of Parishes, comprising the parishes of St Mary's on the Hill, St Nicholas', Carrickfergus and the Loughshore Parishes (Greencastle, Whitehouse, St James' & St Colman's)

REST IN PEACE

Recently Deceased: John Beckett (Virginia, USA)

Months Mind: John O'Hara

Anniversaries: Fr Samuel Kerr, Sr Margaret Mary Kerr, Sadie Mallon (6th), Maureen Sullivan (5th), Michael Keenan, Tony Thompson, Hugh Patrick Reeves, Mary Lillis, Jimmy Lillis, Susan Rea, Daniel Rea, Liam Byrne

MASS INTENTIONS

Saturday

Whitehouse 5pm – John O'Hara Months Mind & Sadie Mallon 6th anniversary

Greencastle 6.30pm – Sr Margaret Mary Kerr anniversary

Sunday St James' 11am - John Beckett (recently deceased; Virginia, USA)

Tuesday

Whitehouse 7pm – Maureen Sullivan 5th anniversary

Wednesday Greencastle 9.30am – Special Intention

MASS SCHEDULE

As the summer draws to a close, our Mass Schedule returns to normal this weekend.

COLLECTION TOTALS FOR AUGUST WEEKLY COLLECTION

Greencastle £930.50, Whitehouse £1,802.00, St James' £2,084.14, St Colman's £1,317.00

SECOND COLLECTION

Greencastle £309.30, Whitehouse £446.00, St James' £204.00, St Colman's £275.00

STIPEND

Greencastle £228.00, Whitehouse £736.00, St James' £340.00, St Colman's £382.00

CATHEDRAL FUND

Greencastle £65.00, Whitehouse £90.00, St James' £46.00, St Colman's £52.00

Thank you for your generosity.



BLESSING OF SCHOOL BAGS

Next weekend, 12th & 13th September, Fr David will be blessing the school bags of all children returning to school. We warmly invite the children and young people of our parish to bring their school bag to any of the Vigil Masses or Sunday Masses in the parish.

We pray for our children and young people as they return to school. May God keep them in His care. May the Holy Spirit open their minds to all that is true, beautiful and good.



The Loughshore Parishes



St Mary's, Greencastle; St Mary, Star of the Sea, Whitehouse;
St James', Whiteabbey & St Colman's, Greenisland



6 September 2026

23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time



SEASON OF CREATION 2026

1 September–4 October

As we prepare to celebrate the first Sunday during the Season of Creation 2026, let us take action, individually and collectively

as parish communities, to care for 'our common home'. The Season of Creation is the annual Christian celebration which invites us to respond in hope and commit to positive action in meeting the challenge and responsibility of caring for creation—'our common home'. This challenge has been underlined by Pope Francis in *Laudato Si'* (2015) and *Laudate Deum* (2023), and by Pope Leo XIV in his message for the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation 2026. As we journey through the Season of Creation, let us each take one action to show care for our planet, 'our common home'.

Please visit the parish website to read the document from the Down & Connor Laudato Si' group.

[Laudato-Si-Season-of-Creation-2026.pdf](#)

A YEAR OF IGNATIAN PRAYER 2026-2027

There are a few places remaining on our immersive programme in Ignatian Spirituality, which returns on Saturday 26th September; offering ten in-person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the Belfast Jesuit Centre and seven online Integrative Practice Pause Points to support prayer, discernment and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available. For dates and registration, please visit: [A Year of Ignatian Prayer](#)

THE CHOSEN – SEASON 2 at Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre.

Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: 4th Sept, 11th Sept, 18th Sept, 25th Sept, 2nd Oct, 9th Oct, 16th Oct, 23rd October.

Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie or 07955 282371

OPENING MASS FOR THE SEASON OF CREATION - Sunday 6th September at 6.00pm, St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast

Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions.

This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water".

DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG

Saturday 19th September. Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am. Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm. The day includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival, then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Monday - Thursday.

ANAM CARA, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening on Monday 14th September at 7.30pm in the Crowne Plaza, Shaws Bridge, Belfast.

This event is free and open to all bereaved parents. You do not need to register in advance.

We also offer an online support group meeting. To find out more call 01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

PETITION IN RELATION TO "SAFE" ABORTION DISPLAY

Belfast City Council wants to light up City Hall on September 28th to celebrate 'International Safe Abortion Day'. This is a deplorable misuse of a public building. There is no such thing as a 'safe' abortion. Tell Belfast City Council to cancel their plans NOW!

Click here to sign the Precious Life petition:

[Stop Abortion Display](#)

BEGINNING EXPERIENCE

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September, 24th October and 21st November). Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

WOLFE TONES GAC returns this Autumn with their Babymentals Programme. 6 week sessions starting Saturday 26th September in St James' Parish Hall 10.30am - 11.30am.

Babymentals is a nursery programme for children aged 2-4 yrs old introducing Gaelic Games through simple, playful and fun activities while building confidence and friendships. Course is free but parents can make a small donation if they wish.

Check out the Facebook page for easy sign up:

[CLG WolfeTones](#)



SUNDAY 6TH SEPTEMBER 2026
TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
 Sunday Cycle A, Psalter Week 3



✦ MASS TIMES & LITURGIES

OUR LADY OF THE ASSUMPTION CHURCH NEWCASTLE

WEEKDAY MASSES:

Mon, Tues, Thurs, Fri at 10am

LITURGY OF THE WORD & HOLY COMMUNION: Wed & Sat 10am

WEEKEND MASSES:

Saturday Vigil Mass at 6pm & Sunday Mass at 11.30am

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH

BRYANSFORD: Open for Private Prayer Only. Open daily from 10am To 5pm

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION:

Fridays, 10.30am-5.00pm

CONFESSIONS

1st & 3rd Saturday, 3.30-4.00pm

BAPTISMS: 1st & 3rd Sat, 3-3.30pm. Book in sacristy after Mass. Bring long birth certificate

WEDDINGS: Arrange with Fr Jim after Mass. Weddings can also be arranged in St Patrick's, Bryansford.

The Parish of Maghera is a part of the Diocese of Down and Connor Trust and operates in accordance with the Diocesan policies. Registered UK Charity No. **XN46141** Charity Name: **Down and Connor Diocesan Trust**

✦ FAMILY OF PARISHES

Parish of Dundrum & Tyrella

Mon-Thurs 9.30am; Sat 10am [Dundrum];

Fri 9.30am [Ballykinkor];

Saturday Vigil 6pm [Ballykinkor];

Sunday Mass 11am [Dundrum]

Parish of Kilmegan & Kilcoo

St. Malachy's Church, Castlewellan

Mon, Tues, Thurs, Fri 9.30am

Saturday Vigil 5pm

Sunday 10am

[Kilcoo]; Sat Vigil 5pm & Sun

Mass 10.00am [Kilcoo];

Mon 9.30am; Wed-Fri 9.30am

Tues 9.30am [Aughlinsnafin]

✦ CONTACT DETAILS

PARISH PRIEST: FR JIM CRUDDEN

Parochial House 24 Downs Road Newcastle 028 437 22401

PARISH MANAGER: BRENDA WEBB

Parochial House 24 Downs Road Newcastle 07840 028461

emails: bwebb@downandconnor.org / brenda@parishofmaghera.com

PARISH SUPPORT & FINANCE

OFFICER: VIRGINIA HUGHES

(On annual leave)

Parish Office, Parochial House, 24 Downs Road, Newcastle, BT33 0AG. Tel: 028 437 22401

Office Hours: Tue-Fri 10am-1pm (Closed Monday). Emails:

Newcastle@downandconnor.org / parishoffice@parishofmaghera.com

Web: www.parishofmaghera.com

FB: Parish of Maghera D&C

To access the Parish webcam:

<https://www.mcni.live/camera/our-lady-of-the-assumption-church-newcastle>

SACRISTANS: STEPHEN BODEN /

ANTHONY CREELMAN

Tel: 028 4372 7691 (after Mass)

PARISH SHOP: EUGENE SMALL

14 Main Street - 028 4372 3399

Opening Time: Mon, Tue, Thu, Fri, Sat - 10.30am-4.30pm (Closed Wednesday)

ROOM/HALL HIRE: PARISH CENTRE

& ST PATRICK'S HALL: EAMON

LENEGHAN / JOE DUGGAN -

Office at 14 Main Street Tel: 028

4372 3399, Office Hours Mon,

Wed & Fri 9.30am-1.30pm

Email: newcastlebookings@downandconnor.org

SAFEGUARDING. If you have a concern, suspicion or wish to

report an allegation of abuse,

please contact: Philip O'Hara,

Diocesan Designated Liaison

Person, 120 Cliftonville Rd,

Belfast BT14 6LA Tel: 07534991124

E: philip.ohara@soddc.org

SVT IF YOU ARE IN NEED OF HELP

Please Contact the St Vincent

de Paul Helpline: 07889780330 or

Lifeline on: 0808 808 8000

✦ MINISTRY OF WELCOME

RECENTLY BAPTISED

Cian Nina / Callan Michael / Rosie Mae / Niamh Christina

BEREAVEMENT MINISTRY

Please remember in your prayers:

RECENTLY DECEASED: Danny Donnan / Cathal McKibbin

ANNIVERSARIES: Derek Murphy /

Catherine Kane / Teresa

McCrickard / Deacon Mark

Leneghan

✦ MASS INTENTIONS

SAT, 5TH - 13TH SEPTEMBER 2026

Sat, 5th 6pm Sheila McEvoy

Sun, 6th 11.30am Fiona, Margaret

& Seamus McKibbin / Thomas &

Anne Walsh / Peter O'Hare /

Annie McQuillan

Mon, 7th 10am Gabrielle Kerr

Fri, 11th 10am Madeleine Blaney

Sat, 12th 6pm Mary McKibbin /

John Harbinson

Sun, 13th 6pm Joseph McFall

"May their souls and the souls of all the

faithful departed rest in peace."

✦ SANCTUARY CANDLES

This week's Sanctuary Candles will

burn for: Fiona, Margaret &

Seamus McKibbin

✦ OFFERTORY COLLECTIONS

16 Aug 2026: £2390.82, Standing

Order: £671.83, Total: £3062.65,

Diocesan Cathedral Fund:

£339.45, Standing Order: £55,

Total: £394.45, Diocesan

Sundries collection (additional)

£464, Holy Day: £703.01. **23 Aug**

2026: £2397.92, Standing Order:

£671.83, Total: £3069.75. **30 Aug**

2026: £2253.95, Standing Order:

£671.83, Total: £2925.78,

Diocesan Sundries collection:

(additional) £427.05, Thank you.

Pope Leo's prayer intention.

September 2026: Water

Management - Let us pray for a

just and sustainable management

of water, a vital resource, so that

everyone may have equal access

to it.

DONATE TO
THE PARISH



PRAYER
PETITION



SCAN QR CODES WITH
YOUR PHONE CAMERA TO:

PARISH
CENTRE / HALL



PARISH
FORMS





VISIT OUR PARISH WEBSITE
www.ourladyqueenofpeacekilwee.com

Parish Office Contact Numbers and Email Addresses

Christ the Redeemer	02890309011	christtheredeemer@downandconnor.org
Derriaghy	028 92660073	derriaghy@downandconnor.org
Nativity	028 90625739	nativity@downandconnor.org
OLQP	028 90616300	ourladyqueenofpeace@downandconnor.org
St Luke's	028 90625739	stlukes@downandconnor.org
St Anne's	02890610112	stannes@downandconnor.org

Pope Leo's prayer intentions for August: For evangelisation in the city.

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find new ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.



The Sacrament of Baptism in Our Lady Queen of Peace will be on the **second Saturday of each month at 2.30pm.**

All parents are required to attend a Pre Baptism meeting which is held on the third Tuesday of each month at 7pm in St Colman's.

KNIT & NATTER: Our Lady Queen of Peace Knit & Natter re-opens on Wednesday 3rd Sept 10.30-12pm. All new members welcome.

If there is anyone in the parish who is **sick and housebound** and would like a priest to visit, please contact the parish office or email kilweeparish@gmail.com

PLEASE NOTE the parish office will be closed this Tuesday & Wednesday.

CAMINO -PARISH PILGRIMAGE

There will be a special pilgrim prayer box in the foyer of our Lady Queen of Peace, Kilwee, for you to place your written intentions. Our pilgrims will physically carry these in their day packs, lifting you up in prayer as they walk, as they reflect together and at the tomb of St. James in Santiago.



ANNIVERSARIES Bridie, Billy and Bernard Rooney
 We pray for those whose anniversaries occur around this time
Eternal rest grant unto them O Lord and may perpetual light shine upon them

FIRST SATURDAY DEVOTIONS will take place in St. Matthias's Church, Glen Road on Saturday, 5th September 2026 3.00 p.m. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament Confessions Act of Consecration 4.00 p.m. Holy Sacrifice of the Mass

TO MAKE A DONATION TO THE PARISH PLEASE VISIT OUR WEBSITE
ourladyqueenofpeacekilwee.com **DONATE BUTTON**
 If you require a box of envelopes, please contact the Parish Office 90616300

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO

Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker **Fr. Mark Quinn**. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student €55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

MATT TALBOT – URBAN MYSTIC

The **Knights of St Columbanus, CK12 Downpatrick**, invite you to a special screening of *Matt Talbot – Urban Mystic* at **Newcastle Community Cinema, St Mary's Hall, Main Street, Newcastle**, on **Friday 4th September at 7.00pm.**

Matt Talbot's remarkable true story of **faith, struggle, addiction and redemption** continues to inspire people throughout the world and offers a powerful message of hope to those affected by addiction and their families.

The evening will also feature **guest speaker Michael Murphy.**

Admission is free, with a suggested donation of **£3 towards costs.** Tea and coffee will be served following the screening. Everyone is welcome -please bring family and friends.

URGENT: STOP ASSISTED SUICIDE - postcards available

The vote on assisted suicide is on 11 September. *Not Dead Yet UK* have provided postcards you can send to your MP to ask them to vote NO to assisted suicide in the vote in the House of Commons on 11 September.

Please take action now - collect a red and white postcard, fill out your details, add a stamp and post it to your MP today!

ROSARY VIGIL FOR LIFE - outside Belfast City Hall on Sunday 30th August at

2.00pm. Join Precious Life in prayer to uphold the sacredness and dignity of unborn life, and pray that Belfast Council will reject plans to illuminate the City Hall in celebration of abortion. For more information, **contact 028 9027 8484 / 07592 280522 or email info@preciouslife.com.**

FIRST SATURDAY DEVOTIONS will take place in St. Matthias's Church, Glen Road on Saturday, 5th September 2026 3.00 p.m. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament Confessions Act of Consecration 4.00 p.m. Holy Sacrifice of the Mass

CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at

Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.



**ST. PATRICK'S BALLYPHILIP
TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
Sunday 6th September 2026**



**Fr Feargal McGrady PP Tel: 028 427 28234 Web: www.portaferryparish.com
Email: portaferry@downandconnor.org Livestream: www.churchmedia.tv
Parish Office: 028 427 28373, Monday – Friday 9.00am – 1.00pm**

Parish Bereavement Ministry

This group offers support for anyone experiencing bereavement. If you would like to talk to a member please Telephone: 07564293692

**ST PATRICK'S COMMUNITY CENTRE CONTACTS:
MADELINE DYNES 07999945936 & JAMES MAGEE 07542530006
During Business Hours**

	St Patrick's Portaferry	St Cooley's Oratory	St Patrick's Ballygalget
Sunday 6 th September TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME	11am Mass		9.30am Mass
Monday 7 th September		7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Novena Mass	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Tuesday 8 th September Nativity of Mary			9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Wednesday 9 th September St Ciaran		7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Mass	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Thursday 10 th September St Peter Claver			9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Friday 11 th September	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass	Eucharistic Adoration 10.00am – 6.00pm	7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Mass
Saturday 12 th September The Holy Name of Mary St Ailbe	5.45pm Adoration 6.30pm Vigil Mass		5.00pm Vigil Mass

Our prayers are requested for the happy repose of the soul of Bernadette Cooper, recently deceased and for the following whose anniversaries occur around this time:

Annie Murray, William Breen, Nancy McHenry, Seamus Smyth, Patsy Andrews, Harry Andrews, Nora McAlister, Margaret Craig, Letitia McVeigh, Catherine Morrin, Sarah McCormick, Annita Crawford, Ena Quinn, Ronan & Muriel Curran, Bobby Adair (Senior), John Savage.

May their souls and the souls of all the faithful departed, rest in peace, Amen.

FIRST SATURDAY PRAYERS: will continue Saturday 5th September at 9.30am in St. Cooley's Oratory. As requested by Our Lady at Fatima, the Rosary and Consecration Prayer will be recited.

MASS INTENTIONS

Saturday 5th September: **Annie Murray, William Breen, Bridie Savage**
Sunday 6th September: **Eamon Fitzsimmons (Months Mind), Nancy McHenry**
Monday 7th September: **Seamus Smyth**
Saturday 12th September: **Paddy Smyth, Dominic Pucci**
Sunday 13th September: **Oliver Lynch**

HARVEST SERVICE in Portaferry Methodist Church, Sunday 27th September at 7pm,
Rev Alan Wardlow, the Past President of the Methodist Church in Ireland will lead the service
alongside other local church leaders. A joint churches choir will help us in our music as we thank
God for his goodness to us. Light refreshments provided after the service.
Food or financial gifts will be welcome but must be shelf stable goods that will be donated to the
local Food Bank. These can be brought to the church Sat morning 26th at 09:30-10:30am or
brought on Sunday evening to the service.



**If you are having difficulties with your expenses ring our confidential
telephone: 07508 549701. We can help.
Donations for the month of August came to £2,205.00.
Thank you for your support and generosity.**

**Weekly Offering: £1,405.00 (Last week's Weekly collection was £1,441.00)
*Thank you for your continued support and generosity.***



PORTAFERRY AND BALLYGALGET BAPTISM MINISTRY

Baptism Information sessions will begin after Halloween. Dates will depend on
Baptisms that are booked via the Parish office.

Parents/ Guardians/ Godparents and Grandparents will be invited to attend. The information
sessions will be:

- Short
- Informal
- Explain the rite of Baptism
- Provide refreshments
- Provide a welcome gift for each child.

Over the next few weeks, we will be setting up 'Baptism trees' in St Patrick's Portaferry and
St Patrick's Ballygalget beside the Baptismal fonts. The name of each child to be baptised will be
hung on the tree as a welcoming gesture from our Parish communities.

May the time of preparation for Baptism be filled with peace, gratitude and the loving presence of
God in our families.

The Folk Group returns this Sunday 6 September at 11.00 mass.

We would welcome new members, young (from P6) and anyone else who enjoys music and
singing and might like to try out being part of a choir.

Anyone interested in joining us please come along any Sunday and learn as you go.

Contact Bernie Doran on 078 4992 7581 or Lorna Spence on 078 5064 8091.

**Notices for the parish bulletin need to be with the parish office by Wednesday 12noon.
Anniversary notices can be left in the anniversary boxes in either church,
(Boxes beside the candle shrines), sent by email, or rang into the office.**

St. Patrick's Community Centre, Portaferry
NEW FOR AUTUMN – Week Beginning 7th September

- Mon.** Tea and Chat, Gentle Exercise, Whist, Quiz 11.00am Text 07873284252
Guitar for Improvers 12.30pm Text 07999945936
Ferry Fit 6.45pm
Ferry Fit 7.45pm
- Tues.** Portaferry Crafters (Textiles) 10.30am Text 07999945936
Netball for P5 to Year10. 6.30pm to 7.30pm Text 07542530006
Ceili Dancing 7.15pm Text 07395200128
Ukulele Beginners 6.30pm; Improvers 7.15pm Text 07999945936
- Wed.** Fit 4 ALL 9.30am (Gently Does It) Text 07999945936
Judo 5.00pm Text 07929905310
- Thurs.** Community Centre Singers 10.30am Text 07999945936
Jo Jingles 12.00pm Text 07395200128
The Hive (Arts & Crafts) 12.30pm Text 07999945936
"Painting Portraits" coming soon 7pm. Watch out for details.
Ferry Film Club (Last Thursday in the month) 7.00pm
Family Film "Song of the Sea" 27th August @7.00pm
Ferry Fit 8.00pm
- Fri.** Party Dance 9.30am Text 07999945936
Walking Group 11.00am
- Sat.** Flower Arranging (1st Sat of each month) 12 noon text 07999945936



Next Bingo Sunday 13th September at 3pm in aid of Air Ambulance.

See our Face Book page for further details: [Stpatrickscmmunitycentreportaferry](#) or text the relevant number with your details and the activity which interests you.

To hire any of our six rooms, please text [07542530006](#) or [07999945936](#)

St Mary's Primary School & Nursery Unit, Portaferry.
Could You Spare an Hour?

As we begin another new school year, St Mary's Primary School & Nursery Unit is seeking volunteers from our parish and wider community to help enrich the lives of our children. Whether you could support reading, maths activities, sports coaching, art, languages, gardening or simply share a skill, hobby or life experience, even a small amount of your time can make a meaningful difference.

If you can spare one hour a week, one hour a month, or help with a particular project, we would love to hear from you.

Contact the school on 028427 28278 or email pgilchrist570@c2kni.net

Share your time. Share your talents. Help our children learn, grow and shine.

BAPTISMS: Portaferry Parish: 2nd & 4th Sunday of the month

Ballygalget Parish: 1st & 3rd Sunday

Please book with the parish office, (**Not the parochial house.**) Portaferry: 02842728373

Mon - Fri 9am - 1pm. Ballygalget: 07398623134 Wed or Fri 9am -1pm.

A copy of your child's Birth Certificate (Long version) is required prior to Baptism date.

BALLYGALGET, PORTAFERRY & ARDKEEN PARISHES

Day Out

FAITH, HERITAGE & COMMUNITY

Explore. Experience. Enjoy Together.



A SHEPHERD'S LIFE AT GLENSHANE COUNTRY FARM
SHEEP SHEARING DEMONSTRATION

Step into the past and experience life on the farm. Watch a live **sheep shearing** demonstration and see working sheepdogs, **hold baby lambs** and more.



THE GORTA EXPERIENCE AT FRIELS

A powerful and moving visitor experience that brings the story of the Great Famine to life.



DINNER AT FRIELS BAR & RESTAURANT, SWATRAGH

Relax and enjoy a delicious **3-course dinner** in the warm and welcoming surroundings of Friels.



TRAVEL IN COMFORT WITH CONNECTIONS IRELAND

- ✓ Modern, luxury coach
- ✓ Air conditioning
- ✓ Spacious seating
- ✓ Friendly, professional driver

PRICE:

£60

PER PERSON
Includes coach travel, all admissions & 3-course dinner

FULLY GUIDED THROUGHOUT THE DAY
Our day out will be fully guided throughout by a professional tour guide accredited by Tour Guides Northern Ireland.

TOUR GUIDES NORTHERN IRELAND

DATE:
THURSDAY
24 SEPTEMBER 2026

DEPARTURE:
LEAVING PORTAFERRY SQUARE AT 9.00 AM SHARP

RETURN:
APPROX. 6.00 PM

WHO CAN JOIN?
Open to everyone in the Parishes of Ballygalget, Portaferry & Ardkeen.

TO SECURE YOUR PLACE CONTACT:
SEAMUS DORRIAN
ON 07813968171

ALL PLACES ALLOCATED ON A FIRST COME FIRST SERVED BASIS.
Don't miss out – book early to avoid disappointment!

Together in Faith. Together in Community.

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2026–2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23rd September and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants.

All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away.

To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org or scan the QR code.



St Colmcille's
Laudato Si' Group
in association with **Trócaire**
— invite you to join us for —

Heroes for Humanity

— of —
A series of workshops exploring
the principles of Catholic Social Teaching
through the lives of four remarkable individuals.

- Wednesday 9 September 2026
Saint Oscar Romero
- Wednesday 16 September 2026
Sister Dorothy Stang
- Wednesday 23 September 2026
Dorothy Day
- Wednesday 30 September 2026
Martin Luther King Jr

Each event will be in
St Colmcille's Parish Hall
191a Upper Newtownards Road,
Belfast, BT4 3JB

Beginning at
7.15 pm

Ending with a cuppa
around **8.45 pm**

All are welcome! ♥

Beginning Experience – Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings this autumn. As part of our commitment to supporting everyone following the death of a child, we are exploring opportunities to further support the entire family. This event is the first, hopefully of many, of that commitment. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. We are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18. This event will take place online on Tuesday 15 September at 7pm.

We are joined by an exceptional panel of local organisations and experts in sibling bereavement.

Michelle Hartnett is a senior play therapist, systemic practitioner, and bereavement specialist currently working with LauraLynn, Ireland's Children's Hospice, with over 15 years' experience supporting families through serious illness, grief, and loss. Michelle holds an MSc in Systemic Therapy and an MSc in Bereavement Studies and is a Grief Consultant with Middlesex University. She also holds a postgraduate certificate and diploma in Play Therapy from NUI Galway.

Anna May is founder of The Student Grief Network and Executive Head of Grief Programmes at Kaplan International. She lost her brother as a child and her dad as a young adult and is passionate about improving the support that people get following a bereavement. Anna is also a writer and artist, interested in how creativity can help us explore difficult human experiences and build more connected ways of living.

We are also joined by Childhood Cancer Ireland, Jacinta's Smile, and Rainbows.

In the world of grief and loss, siblings, especially adult siblings, are often called 'forgotten mourners.' Siblings face not only their own loss, but often the loss of their parents and families as they knew them, the loss of the only person who was present of their whole life, and often the loss of a close friend. We believe this is why it is essential to begin forming an all-island bereavement support for adult siblings facing all kinds of sibling loss. We hope you can join us in this effort by sharing about this Bereavement Information Evening with your community.

Bereaved parents and adult bereaved siblings are warmly invited to register here:
[Register here for Anam Cara Online Bereavement Information Evening](#)



6th September 2026

THE PARISHES OF PORTSTEWART, PORTRUSH & BUSHMILLS & ST. MALACHY'S COLERAINE

North Connor Pastoral Community

Fr Kevin McGuckien PP Telephone: 028 7083 2534 Email: k.mcguickien@downandconnor.org
TWENTY THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME



Sunday A / Psalter Week 3

MASS TIMES

STAR OF THE SEA CHURCH, PORTSTEWART

TUESDAY: 7.00pm
WEDNESDAY – FRIDAY: 9.30am
SATURDAY VIGIL MASS: 4.30pm
SUNDAY MASS: 10.00am

CONFESSION:

SATURDAY: 4.00pm

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION - THURSDAY 10am-5pm

ST. MALACHY'S CHURCH, COLERAINE

TUES, THURS & SAT: 10.00am

PLEASE NOTE THERE IS NO MASS IN ST. MALACHY'S CHURCH ON FRIDAY THIS COMING WEEK

SUNDAY MASS: 11.30am & 5.00pm

CONFESSION:

SATURDAYS: After 10.00am Mass

SUNDAYS: 4.30-4.50pm

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH, PORTRUSH

MON, TUES & FRI: 10.30am

SUNDAY MASS: 12 Noon

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION - FRIDAY 11am-1pm

OUR LADY & ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, BALLYMONEY

MON & WED: 10.00am

FRIDAY: 7.00pm

SATURDAY VIGIL MASS: 6.00pm

SUNDAY MASS: 9.30am

COLLECTIONS

PORTSTEWART

Last weekend's Collections: Weekly Offering: £1750

Our account details are: Portstewart Parish

Sort Code: 95-04-28 Account number: 91011049

PORTRUSH

Last weekend's Collections: Weekly Offering: £697

Our account details are: Portrush Parish

Sort Code: 95-06-79 Account number: 00254207

ST. MALACHY'S COLERAINE

Last weekend's Collections: Weekly Offering: £1458

Our account details are: St Malachy's Church

Sort Code: 90-48-00 Account number: 88609151

THANK YOU FOR YOUR SUPPORT AND GENEROSITY!

PORTSTEWART

Parish Support Officer: 028 7083 2534

Email: portstewart@downandconnor.org

Parish Office Hours: Mon 9.00am -1.00pm

Tues 2.00pm-5.00pm, Wed & Fri: 9.00am – 5.00pm

REST IN PEACE

RECENT: Dr. James Harley, Jody Campbell, Paul O'Neill, Sean Hughes, Stacey McLaughlin, Bill O'Doherty, Brian McCaffrey, Mary Convery, Mark Oakley RIP

ANNIVERSARIES: Margaret Lynch, Fearghal Devlin, Tony Doherty, Jean Loughrey, Sarah Sweeney, Andrew Diamond, Reggie Smyth, Teresa McClarnon, Sarah Brown, Paddy McGarry, John Mullan, Bobby Stuart, Maryanne McCrory RIP

NEXT WEEKEND – 12 & 13 SEPT (PORTSTEWART)

VIGIL MASS: 4.30pm

Minister of the Word: Seamus O'Hara

Eucharistic Ministers: Ruth McGuckian, Tracy McMorrough, Alison Rankin/Deirdre McCann

SUNDAY MASS: 10.00am

Minister of the Word: Curtis White

Eucharistic Ministers: Julie Roantree*, Deirdre Bannon*, Mark Donaghy*, Liam Brolly

COLERAINE

Email: coleraine@downandconnor.org

Parish Office: Thurs: 9.00 – 5.00pm

REST IN PEACE

RECENT: Vincent McGuigan, Roisin Ward, Eileen Morrison, Suzanne McEvoy RIP

ONE YEAR AGO: Paul Duffy RIP

ANNIVERSARIES: Rose Young, Sarah Brown, James Crawford, Mary McGill, Brian Kneeland, Margaret Kneeland, Patricia McMullan, Andrew Diamond RIP

PORTRUSH

Fr Patrick Delargy: 028 7082 3388

Email: portrush@downandconnor.org

PARISH OFFICE: Tuesday – 9.00am-1.00pm

NEXT SUNDAY – 13 SEPT (PORTRUSH) 12.00 Noon

Minister of the Word: Kate Magee

Eucharistic Minister: Marie McAuley

REST IN PEACE

RECENT: Gerard Britovšek, Helen Scullion RIP

ANNIVERSARIES: Fr. John Madden PP, Sarah Brown, Brian Minihan RIP

CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - STANDING IN THE BREACH



A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at

Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19

September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme

of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further info, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435/email sean@catholicminute.co.uk



HEALTHY AND SMART CHILDREN FOUNDATION

Dr Christian will be making an appeal for his charity at the weekend Masses in Portrush and Ballymoney next weekend. 12th & 13th Sept. Fund raising for the GOD'S GIFT OF SIGHT project, to provide free cataract surgeries for 100 blind people and 3,000 pairs of glasses for poor people in churches and communities in Nigeria.

Charity Name: Healthy And Smart Children Foundation

Bank Name: Charity Aid Foundation Bank

Account Number: 73016017 Sort code: 405240

You can also make direct debit to support our charity in the care for many poor children in

Africa www.healthysmartchildren.org



ST. PATRICK'S INDOOR BOWLING CLUB

Our Bowling Club will commence bowling on Sunday 13th September at 7.00 pm in St. Patrick's Hall, Portrush. This year the League has been restructured into 3 Sections meaning there will be fewer Inter-club matches and more nights for social bowling. Anyone wishing to join the Club come along on Sunday 13th or any Sunday that suits. If you are new to the sport, we have Bowls available, and members will make you welcome.



BLESSING OF ANIMALS

Once again, our Family of Parishes will be marking the Church's Season of Creation with a blessing of pets and animals. This year the blessing takes place in the grounds of Our Lady & St Patrick's in Ballymoney on Sunday 27th September at 2pm. All welcome to attend.



We are blessed to be able to offer two opportunities to our parish community to honour Our Blessed Mother Mary. Parishioners are warmly invited to join either pilgrimage, depending on what suits your schedule and spiritual needs. Both are beautiful opportunities to enjoy time away from the noise and busyness of our lives and immerse ourselves into a day of prayer and reflection.





Parish Office: 02890610112
www.saintannesparish.net

St. Anne's Parish

Fr. Martin O'Hagan, PP
Rev Pat McNeill, Deacon
Sr. Mary Murray, Parish Sister

Parish Centre: 07762909559
Email: stannes@downandconnor.org

Twenty-Third Sunday in Ordinary Time
Where two or three are gathered in my name....



Mass this Week

St Anne's
Saturday 5pm Vigil (Confessions 4.30pm)
Sunday 11.00 am
Monday & Wednesday 10.00 am

St Colman's Sunday 12.00 noon
Tuesday 10.00 am

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament this week:
St Anne's Monday 12 noon to 1 pm

Parish Office:
Closed until 9am Tuesday 15th September.

Parish WhatsApp Group –keep up to date with what is happening in our parish community. Text your full name and number to **07565012056** to be added.

YOUR GIVING:

This Weekend 5th & 6th September
Weekly Offering
Monthly Offering for Priests

Last Weekend –
Weekly Offering-Envelopes £1004.00 Loose £616.30
Building & Maintenance Fund £312.50

Set up a **Standing Order**. You can download the forms from our website...or **Donate Online** to St. Anne's Parish
A/C No. 07707787 Sort Code 93 83 00

Solar Panel Water Project - 30th August

The Basement Club and friends would like to thank all those who attended their fundraiser on Sunday 30th August. To those who attended and participated so generously, to those who donated cakes, gifts etc, we are extremely grateful. A total of £2655 was raised at the event on Sunday, this combined with £2450 from a GoFund Me appeal running alongside means that plans can progress to build 2 Solar panelled water stations in the Uttar Pradesh region of Northern India. 1 water station will be dedicated to the memory of Catherine McGinley, the other to deceased members of the Basement.

We Remember:

Recently Deceased
Months Mind -
Anniversary -

Noreen Fegan
John Johnston
Joseph McGreevy

Opening Mass for the Season of Creation

6.00 pm on Sunday, 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions.

This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept-4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water". 1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (Is 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue."

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each day at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All welcome; no registration required. Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23 Oct.
Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk

Cantor Training Adults (18+) involved in parish music are invited to take part in Cantor Training at St Joseph's Parish Centre, Belfast. Training takes place on Saturday 3 October, 17 October and 24 October, from 10.00am to 3.00pm (registration from 9.30am). Attendance at all three days is required for commissioning as a parish cantor. Application form on St Anne's website: www.saintannesparish.net or at your parish office or

St Colmcille's
Laudato Si' Group
in association with **trócaire**
— invite you to join us for —
Heroes for Humanity
A series of workshops exploring the principles of Catholic Social Teaching through the lives of four remarkable individuals.



Wednesday
9 September 2026
Saint Oscar Romero



Wednesday
16 September 2026
Sister Dorothy Stang



Wednesday
23 September 2026
Dorothy Day



Wednesday
30 September 2026
Martin Luther King Jr



Each event will be in
St Colmcille's Parish Hall
191a Upper Newtownards Road,
Belfast, BT4 3JB



Beginning at
7.15 pm



Ending with a cuppa
around **8.45 pm**

All are welcome! ♥

Beginning Experience – is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Down and Connor Vocations Newsletter available in the porch and on the Parish Website: www.saintannesparish.net

DIOCESAN NOTICES – All available on the parish website:
www.saintannesparish.net

The Liturgy

Sunday Mass

Saturday: 6.00 pm (Vigil Mass)

Sunday: 9.30 am
12.00 noon

Weekday Mass Times

Monday: 7.00 pm
Tuesday: 9.30 am
Wednesday: 9.30 am
Thursday: 9.30 am
Friday: 7.00 pm
Saturday: 12 noon

Confession

Monday: 7.30 pm – 8.00 pm
Friday: 6.30 pm – 7.00 pm
Saturday: 12.30 pm – 1.00 pm &
5.30 pm – 6:00 pm

Eucharistic Adoration

Monday: 7.30 pm – 8.00 pm

Baptisms

1st & 3rd Sunday of the Month at 1.30pm
Please contact the Parish Office to book
(One month's notice required)

Marriages

At least 6 months' notice required prior
to date of Marriage.
Please contact Fr Sheehan

PARISH OFFERTORY COLLECTION

(Total includes Basket Collections, Standing Orders and Dona Donations)

Weekly Collection 30th August: £6048.47

Mass Intentions for week ahead

Mon 7th Sept 11am: *Funeral - Patricia Boyle*
Mon 7th Sept 7pm: *John & Christopher Cushinan (A)*
Tues 8th Sept 9.30am: *Michael Connolly (A)*
Wed 9th Sept 9.30am: *Special Intention*
Thurs 10th Sept 9.30am: *Michael Lynch (MM)*
Fri 11th Sept 7pm: *Michael McKeever (A)*
Sat 12th Sept 12 Noon: *Rosaleen McBurney (MM)*
Sat 12th Sept 6pm: *Joseph Murtagh (A)*



Saint Brigid's Parish

23rd Sunday in O T
6th September 2026, Year A

Parish Priest: Fr Michael Sheehan **Tel:** 028 9066 5409

Parish Office: 028 9066 5409; (9 am - 1 pm Weekdays)

Address: 40 Derryvolgie Avenue, Belfast, BT9 6FP

Email: stbrigids@downandconnor.org **Website:** stbrigidsparishbelfast.org

Livestream/Webcam: youtube.com/@stbrigidsparishbelfast



23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time

First Reading: Reading from the prophet Ezekiel Ezk 33:7-9
If you do not speak to the wicked man, I will hold you responsible for this death.

Responsorial Psalm: Ps 94: 1-2.6-9
O that today you would listen to his voice! Harden not your hearts.

Second Reading: Reading from the St Paul to the Romans Rm 13:8-10
Love is the answer to every one of the commandments.

Gospel: According to Matthew Mt 18:15-20
If he listens to you, you have won back your brother.

Anniversary List

Please pray for Breige McKeating recently deceased; Rosaleen McBurney and Michael Lynch whose month's mind it is and for those whose anniversaries are at this time: Charles and Elizabeth Sheil, Sally Giles, John Cushinan, Christopher Cushinan, Mary Elinor Waters, Terry and Clare McGuinness, James Millar, Patrick Curran, Patrick McAnulty, Frances Donnelly, Mary Larkin, Arthur McDonnell, Michael Connolly, Michael McKeever;

May they rest in peace

St Brigid's Parent and Toddler Group will start back on Thursday 17th September from 10.00am until 11.45am in St Brides Parish Hall.

Food Bank Collection

St Brigid's support to the South Belfast foodbank makes a huge difference to the lives of people living in poverty.

Non perishable food items can be donated after all Masses on the **5th/6th September 2026**. The August collection weighed in at 273.95kgs.

Thank you for your support.

*List of **items currently most needed**: Tinned fish; Tinned meat; Tinned vegetables; Tinned tomatoes; Rice; Rice pudding and Custard; Coffee; Tea; Cooking sauces; UHT milk; Jam/Honey/Spreads; Biscuits; Large sized nappies(5+); Detergent; Toilet roll; Toiletries*

? LIFE AFTER ALPHA ? INVITATION TO CONTINUE THE JOURNEY ChristLife 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' course



When Jesus called his first Disciples he said, "Come Follow Me." He still makes that call to us today. The 'ChristLife' series is an opportunity for you to respond to that call and continue that journey you embarked upon with Alpha.

FOLLOWING CHRIST is a 7-week course with a one day Retreat to help you grow as a disciple of Jesus. The course will commence on **TUESDAY 15 SEPTEMBER 2026 at 7:00pm in HOLY ROSARY PARISH CENTRE, 503 Ormeau Road, BT7 3GR.**

Each evening will follow a format similar to the Alpha Course and include a video presentation and small group discussions each evening. We will also have time for tea and coffee and a little something to eat! The evening should last no more than a couple of hours.

To register for 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' course, please send your full name, your e-mail address and mobile telephone number to stbrigids@downandconnor.org

ST BRIGID'S MORNING PRAYER

We are recommencing morning prayer at **7.30am on 14th September 2026 in the Side Chapel** and each subsequent Monday until the beginning of Advent during which we will meet each weekday morning until just before Christmas.

All parishioners and friends are warmly welcomed

The format follows the Morning Office includes a reading and reflection on the gospel and introduces the rhythm of the daily office and especially the psalms to our daily lives. Why not come along and experience for yourselves?

G.I.F.T - Growing In Faith Together

A fun-filled , faith-based programme connecting our young people to one another, to their Parish and to God.

GIFT DATES 2026/27

GIFT 5 (Year 12) - 27 September, 4 October, 11 October, 18 October 2026

GIFT 2 (Year 9) - 15 November, 22 November, 29 November, 6 December 2026

GIFT 1(Year 8) - 10 January, 17 January, 24 January, 31 January 2027

GIFT 4 (Year 11) - 28 February, 7 March, 14 March, 21 March 2027

GIFT 3 (Year 10) - 25 April, 2 May, 9 May, 16 May 2027

St Brigid's One World Group Annual Collection and Standing Order Appeal 2026

Please help people suffering from extreme poverty in developing countries whose needs are growing every year because of:

- the spiralling costs of food and other basic commodities
- devastating floods and droughts caused by climate change
- the impacts of war
- growing inequalities between rich and poor
- the significant reduction of aid from Governments.



We will hold our Annual Collection and Standing Order Appeal next weekend on 12 and 13 September. Gift Aid envelopes & Standing Order forms will be distributed this weekend.

Please contribute to our Annual Collection and/or consider making a regular donation by setting up a Standing Order online with your bank or by completing a Standing Order form.

If you are a UK taxpayer and Gift Aid your donations, we can claim a further 25% of the amount from HMRC.

**Donations may be made electronically or Standing Orders set up online
Account No 68825172 Sort Code 90-22-07**

For information, email stbrigids1wg@gmail.com or phone Kevin on 07525634440

Ashleigh group sacramental preparation classes for Primary 4 children will commence in October. These classes are for children who live in the parish but do not attend St Bride's P.S. Classes will take place on a Tuesday evening. Please contact kathrynmorrissey1@gmail.com by September 22nd to register your interest. **SPACES ARE LIMITED.**



Season of Creation 2026 (1 September – 4 October). Join us ...

The Season of Creation is the annual Christian celebration which invites us to respond in hope and commit to positive action meeting the challenge and responsibility to care for creation - our common home. The challenge has been underlined by Pope Francis in *Laudato Si'* (2015) *Laudato Deum* (2023) and Pope Leo XIV in his message for World Day of Prayer for Care of Creation 2025 .

As we journey through the Season of Creation from 1 September through to the feast-day of St Francis of Assisi on 4 October, let us each take one action to care for our planet, our common home.

The theme for this season is 'Living Water' symbolised by a small stream flowing from the Temple of God - growing into a deep and powerful river. *Every act of care for creation becomes part of a global stream of hope*" (Living Water Season of Creation 2026).

What action will we take in this season to show care for our planet, our common home?

Action an Eco - tip

- Endeavour to buy locally sourced food on one shopping visit
- Make one journey on foot or use public transport
- Select one day and turn off all non- essential lights

Start the conversation with family and friends – what can we do to care for our common home? Involve young people in our conversations – their voice matters - they will inherit the planet that we create.

Read and consider what others are saying

Keep informed and join wider discussions by visiting info@jointhetodtogether.org
Read My Appeal (paragraphs 13 - 16) *Laudato Si'* - On Care for Our Common Home - visit www.vatican.va

Contribute your ideas and talents

Join our parish 'Care for Common Home' group to share ideas on eco-tips and suggestions for future talks/events — contact through the Parish Office.

Let's rise to the challenge

Pope Frances had every confidence that we can make change happen.

'All of us can cooperate as instruments of God for the care of creation, each according to his or her own culture, experience, involvements and talents' (LS14).

St Brigid's Care for Our Common Home Group

We are continuing our discussions around moving to solar panels - an action to reduce parish building carbon emissions.

St Brigid's Care for Our Common Home Group

Stretch. Breathe. Connect.

The Parish Community Association welcomes you back to our much-loved **Yoga sessions**—designed to refresh your body and lift your spirit.

Starting: Monday 14th September 2026

Time: 12:30 pm (*doors open at 12:15 pm – come early and settle in!*)

Venue: St Brigid's Parish Centre – Main Hall

Open to: All ages, all abilities – absolutely everyone is welcome!

Why you'll love it:

- **Expert guidance** – Learn poses safely and at your own pace
- **Just £5** – Quality wellness that won't break the bank
- **Friendly vibes** – A lovely way to meet new people in our community

Please bring your own yoga mat – you'll need it for the full session.

Come as you are. Leave feeling brighter.

Give it a go – your mind (and body) will thank you.

We can't wait to see you there!

Gaeilge agus Cultúr weekly in St Bride's Parish Hall

Tuesday 8th September, 2pm to 3pm. Irish for those with a little.

Thursday 10th September, 10am to 11am Irish for beginners.

Thursday 17th September, 1.30 to 3.30 amateur dramatics, no experience necessary.

Thursday 24th September 6.30 to 8.30 Gaeilge Choir, no fluency required.

Contact Máire for more information 07748482025/ amharcababu@hotmail.com

68th Belfast Scout Group

For Boys and Girls aged 6 to 14 yrs

Weekly meetings of fun and adventure in St John's Malone Parish Halls every Monday night starting on Monday 7th September. Places available in all sections

For more information contact Gavan Duffy glv.68thbelfast@gmail.com



St Gerard's Parish Weekly Bulletin

6th September 2026



Welcome to Celebrate Today's Liturgy Mass Times

Saturday Vigil- 18.30

Sunday Mass—10.30

Monday—Liturgy of The Word 9.30

Tuesday Mass -9.30

Wednesday Mass- 9.30

Thursday OMPH Novena Prayer Service- 9.30

Thursday OMPH Novena Mass—19.30

Friday Mass - 9.30

Saturday Silent Meditation—9.30

Holy Days Vigil 7.30pm Morning 9:30

Reconciliation Saturday 17.30—18.15
otherwise by appointment with Priest

Baptisms 2nd and 4th Sundays—Baptism
Preparation course 5pm on 1st Monday of each
month for those wishing to have their child Baptised
in St Gerard's—ring Parish office to arrange both.

Priest Fr Patrick O'Keeffe CSsR ADM

Parish Office 028 90 774833
726 Antrim Road (office hrs M-F 9.30-1.30)

Email stgerards@downandconnor.org

Website stgerardsparish.org

Church Services: Our live streaming web
address has been updated. To access MCN
Media, please go to www.mcn.live on your web
browser. THE CHURCH WEBCAM CAN BE ACCESSED
VIA
mcn.live/Camera/st-gerards-church-newtownabbey
(Playback available on **Recorded** services only -
Recording Requests can be made through Parish
office)

**For Anniversary Mass Intentions on preferred dates—
Please (if possible) make requests 3-4 weeks in advance*

The Apostles' Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty,
Creator of heaven and earth,
and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit,
born of the Virgin Mary,
suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died and was buried;
he descended into hell;
on the third day
he rose again from the dead;
he ascended into heaven,
and is seated at the right hand of
God the Father almighty;
from there he will come to judge the
living and the dead.
I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic Church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and life everlasting. Amen.

Congratulations to Mrs Briege Smyth

We are delighted to announce that His Holiness Pope Leo XIV
has conferred the Benemerenti Medal on Mrs Briege Smyth in
recognition of her lifetime of dedicated service to St Gerard's
Church and Parish.
This prestigious papal honour is a fitting tribute to Briege's faithful
commitment, generosity, and years of service to our parish
community.
Please join us in congratulating Briege on this achievement and in
keeping her in your prayers as she receives this special recognition.
The Benemerenti Medal will be presented to Briege during the
10.30am Mass on Sunday, 6 September 2026.
All are warmly welcome to attend and share in this joyful
celebration. Tea and coffee will be served after Mass, providing an
opportunity for parishioners and friends to congratulate Briege
personally.
We thank Briege for her outstanding contribution to parish life and
celebrate this well-deserved honour with her and her family.

Our Parish Associate Pilgrims Collection for the Down and Connor
Diocesan Pilgrimage will take place this weekend 5th and 6th
September.

**Saturday 4th October at 3pm—Blessing of Pets— on this special day
of the Feast of St Frances all our pets are welcome to St Gerard's
Church for a special blessing**

Opening Mass for the Season of Creation
6.00 pm on Sunday, 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall
Street, Belfast

Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions.

This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4
Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action
for our common home under the theme "Living Water".

1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In
his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to
"beat swords into ploughshares" (Is 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for
nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into
life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external
change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a
deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who
will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue."

The **Rise & Shine Trust** wishes to thank the parishioners of St Gerard's
for your kind donations that amounted to £710.16 and 70 euro.
Remember if you know anyone who would benefit from next years
trip please contact

**Maurice on 07711504821 mauricediamond@gmail.com or visit
www.riseandshine.ie.**

LOCAL IRISH DANCE CLASSES – SEPTEMBER The Carson Academy of
Irish Dance welcomes **girls & boys aged 4+** to our fun and friendly
beginner Irish dance classes. **Mayfield Village Hall** Every Tuesday |
5:30–6:30pm **Glengormley Integrated Nursery School** Every Saturday
| 10:00–11:00am Classes commence **week of 7th September.**

Enquiries & Booking: WhatsApp: 07803 785103

Email: carson_acd@icloud.com **New beginners are very welcome!**

Craobh Naomh Pádraig will begin Irish/Gaeilge classes on
Wednesday 16 September 2026 at 7 p.m.
Classes will be held in **Arás Mhic Reachtain, 283-289 Antrim Road**
(opposite waterworks).

Term will last for 12 weeks finishing on Wed 9 December.

Cost per term for adults £30. Teenagers - no cost.

All levels available: bunrang, meánrang, meán rang uachtar, ardrang
and class for teenagers.

EUCARISTIC ADORATION – Down and Connor Diocese is renewing
and developing its **Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee** in order to
increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout
the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting at
ONE of these venues

Thur 1st October The Parish Centre Ballymena – 2 Broughshane Road
BT43 7DX 8pm

Fri 2nd October St Patrick's Centre Downpatrick – Market Street BT30
6LZ 8pm

Registration from 7.30pm . See poster in the church porch for details

New Lodge Grotto Monday 7th September 6.30pm Rosary at the
Grotto 7pm Holy Mass at the Grotto with Fr Francis O'Brien and Fr
John O'Laverty Followed by refreshments All welcome!

EVERYONE IS INVITED TO STAY AFTER MASS THIS WEEKEND
AND JOIN US FOR COFFEE/TEA AND CHAT

PASTORAL COMMUNITY

HOLY FAMILY PARISH CLERGY

Very Rev. Michael Spence PP

Rev. John O'Laverty CC

Rev. Brendan Dowd Deacon

Mass Times

HOLY FAMILY CHURCH,

14 Newington Avenue, Belfast, BT15 2HP

Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 10.30am

Holydays: 9.15am

Weekdays: Mon–Wed 9.15am

Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Wed at 9.15am

First Saturday Devotions: First Saturday of the month at 10am

ST THERÉSE OF LISIEUX CHURCH,

71 Somerton Road, Belfast, BT15 4DE

Sunday: 9am & 12pm

Holydays: 7pm Vigil & 10am

Weekdays: Thurs–Sat 10am

Eucharistic Adoration: Mon–Sat, 10am–4pm

ST. PATRICK'S PARISH

CLERGY

Very Rev. Francis O'Brien PP

Mass Times

ST PATRICK'S CHURCH

199 Donegall St Belfast BT1 2FL

Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 9am, 11am & 6pm

Holydays: Please check parish website and Facebook

Weekdays: Tues, Wed, Thurs 10am

Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help

every Wednesday at 10am

Novena in honour of St. Anthony and Blessing with the relic of

St Anthony of Padua every Tuesday at 10am

Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to
renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down &
Connor will take place on:

Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering
Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast.

This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who
would like to support a fresh start, new energy,
and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be
delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

Anam Cara, the organisation that supports bereaved
parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening
on **Monday 14th September at 7.30pm in the Crowne
Plaza, Shaws Bridge, Belfast.**

This event is free and open to all bereaved parents
regardless of the age their child died, the circumstances of
their death, or how recent their death was. You do not need
to register in advance.

We also offer an online support group meeting. To find out
more call 01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

We're grateful for your help in raising awareness of
this free support for bereaved parents in your parish
community. For more information visit www.anamcara.ie.

September 2026 Shopping List

- Coffee
- Soup
- Jam
- Tea
- Baked beans



northbelfast.foodbank.org.uk
Registered Charity in Northern Ireland (94C100215)

Ending hunger together



May They Rest In Peace

Recently Deceased

Months Mind

Pat Rogan

Anniversaries

James Richard Hann, John Hicks, Frank McGoldrick, Malachy Quail,

Patrick and Mary Anne Canning, Denis and Ellen Lane



Church of St. MacNissi

TWENTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
15TH & 16TH AUGUST 2026

WEEKDAY MASSES - Tuesday-7.00pm,
 Wednesday – Friday 9.30am

WEEKEND MASSES

Saturday 6pm Sunday 10am

CONFESSIONS: On request after all Masses

EXPOSITION OF THE BLESSED SACRAMENT

Mon-10am-11am Tues - 5:30pm-7pm

LEGION OF MARY Tuesday evening in the
 Parish Centre after Mass. Fatima statue
 visitation. To have the statue in your home or
 to have your intentions prayed for;
 ☎07798865887

PARISH CENTRE

Prayer Meeting - Wednesday 7:45pm

THE ROSARY GROUP each Thurs at 6pm in
 the Church and 'live' online mcn media.

DIVINE MERCY Friday 3pm

MONTHS MIND:

Ali McDowell – Sat 15th Aug 6pm.

ANNIVERSARIES:

Eddie McStravick (1st Anniversary) Sat 15th Aug 6pm
 Teresa Donnelly, Elizabeth McGuigan,
 Shirley Murray, Peggy Donnelly, Charlie Devlin,
 Madge Creighton, John Sawyer, Tom McCormack,
 Thomas Gavin, Thomas Cardwell, Sarah Martin
 Patrick McKenna, Charlie O'Boyle, Brian Kerr,
 Mary Jane Loughran, Annie Hamilton,
 Rosaleen Kelly, Alice Hurrell, Mary Kate Fallon.

INTENTIONS WK BEGINNING 17-August

MONTHS MIND

Joseph McNally – Tue 18th Aug 7pm

ANNIVERSARY MASS

Jim McKenna (1st Anniversary) Sat 22nd Aug 6pm

Our priest is obligated to offer **Sunday Mass**
 on behalf of **ALL** the people (*pro populo*) in the
 parish. The deceased are remembered in our
Prayers of the Faithful.

FEAST DAYS THIS WEEK

Mon 17th Aug – Our Lady of Knock

Wed 19th Aug – St John Eudes

Thur 20th Aug – St Bernard

Sat 22nd Aug - Mary, Queen of Heaven

PARISH WEEKLY COLLECTION £1,279.00

Thank you for your support of our parish.
 To set up a standing order for Direct Debit
 please call or email the parish office to arrange.

MINISTERS OF THE WORD

22/8/26	Geraldine Ibbotson	Sibéal Dumbleton
---------	--------------------	------------------

EUCCHARISTIC MINISTERS

22/8/2026	Vincent O'Connell	Gerard McBride
	Brian Fitzsimon	John Heffron
	David Skelly	Gerard Dougan

Congratulations to

Tasha Craig & John Martin

who had their relationship consecrated in the
 Sacrament of Matrimony on Friday 14th August

CLEANING TEAM 3 on Monday 17th August

SVP Help Line is 0750 854 9606

OFFICE OPEN Monday–Friday 9- 1.pm

CONTACT; MOBILE 07734 570890

Or EMAIL randalstown@downandconnor.org

EMERGENCY CONTACT ONLY 07834 383314

PARISH WEBSITE To watch Mass online
 Select WEBCAM from the parish website menu
 or go to mcn.live/cameras/st-macnissis.
 Funerals/weds recorded at the specific request
 of the family

PARISH DRAW FOR AUGUST will be held on
 Wednesday 19th August at 4.30pm in the
 Parochial House.

YOUTH MINISTRY - SPIRIT AND TRUTH !!

every Wednesday in St
 MacNissi's Church
 7pm- 8pm (**Yr 8 – 6th Form Welcome**)



**EVER YOUNG" YOUTH GROUP FOR P7
 LEAVERS** - who will be entering Yr 8 in Sept! @
**St Oliver Plunkett's Church Toome every
 Sunday 4pm - 6pm"**

PILGRIMAGE TO FATIMA Belfast International
 7 Nights F/B Avenida Hotel **14th/21st** August
£845pps. Contact **Joe 07776425631**

KNOCK TRIP 8th & 9th Sep 16 seater bus
 leaving St. MacNissi's Church at 8.am. Luncheon
 en-route, evening meal and b & b at
 Knock House Hotel £185pps. (night stay)
Contact 07519915325

"MEDJUGORJE YOUTH PILGRIMAGE 2027:

Our Youth Minister Dean Millar will be taking a group of young people aged 14 - 18 from Antrim, Randalstown & Duneane Parishes to Medjugorje next summer. If you would be interested in this, please share an expression of interest with Dean at d.millar@downandconnor.org or via Whatsapp at 07593 925676

August & September 2026 @ Lough Derg
A pilgrimage has a vital part to play in our life of faith, for it removes us from our daily routines, and gives us time and space to encounter God more deeply. Pope Leo XIV

One Day Retreats – Guided Days of Prayer and Reflection - places available on August 18th, 22nd, 23rd, 29th and 31st September 5th, 6th, 9th, 12th, 15th, 19th and 20th Admission €50. Group discounts available. Advance Booking Essential .

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on **Sunday, 6 September** at **Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry City**. The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie.

St Joseph Men's Camino Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker **Fr. Mark Quinn**. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

The **Knights of St Columbanus, CK12 Downpatrick**, invite you to a special screening of *Matt Talbot – Urban Mystic* at **Newcastle Community Cinema, St Mary's Hall, Main Street, Newcastle**, on **Friday 4th September at 7.00pm**. Admission is free.

MONDAY WEEKLY SALSA CLASSES

7-8pm in Tir na nÓg old clubhouse. All welcome, no partner required Contact 07713388035

THURSDAY 10.30am Our **WALKING CLUB** meets at the Parish Centre. Welcome Tea and Coffee on return.

TÍR NA NÓG LOTTO Tues 11/08/2026

JACKPOT WINNER:

WINNING NUMBERS: 6,13,18,26

£25 WINNERS: Rory McVeigh, Marg D Bunting, Michael McNally, Dermot Corr.

Jackpot
£5,000

Next week
Tues 18/08/2026

Kickham's GAC Wed 12/08/2026

WINNING NUMBERS: 4,8,19,24

£30 WINNERS:

Yvonne Loughran & Frances Bateson

Next week's draw is on Wednesday 19/08/2026 at 8.30pm. Tickets must be bought by 7.30pm.

Jackpot £6,400 Tickets are available online at <https://member.clubspot.app/club/creggan-kickhams-gac/fundraisers> from outlets in town or your usual ticket sellers.

COMMUNITY ADVICE Antrim and N'Abbey (Formerly Citizens Advice)

Monday from 1.30pm to 4.30pm, in Arches. No appointment needed as this is a *drop-in* service

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND (2-4 OCT 2026)

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2nd to Sunday 4th October 2026 at the "Focolare Centre" "Curryhills", Prosperous, Co. Kildare.

Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage.

• www.marriageencounter.ie

Parish of St MARY'S on the HILL 16th Aug 2026

Churches: St Mary's on the Hill & St Bernard's

PRIESTS OF THE PARISH

Fr Pat Sheehan & Fr Aidan Kerr

PARISH OFFICE 028 90832979

Lorraine Carlin & Patricia Gillespie

Opens Mon – Friday 9am – 1pm

165 Antrim Road. BT36 7QR

e-mail: stmarysoth@downandconnor.org

website: www.stmarysonthehill.online

RECENTLY DECEASED

Liz Dearlove, Harmin Pk

Alicia Devine, Tobar Glen Crescent

Catherine Mooney, Moyola Manor

MONTH'S MIND

Raymond Hassan, Michael McCorry

ANNIVERSARIES

Patrick Hughes, Martin Brogan, Billy Moran,
William McCotter, Angela McClelland, Jim Curran,
Veronica Mulholland, Sarah Convery, William Burns,
Baby Michael McKee, May O'Toole, Charlotte
Fletcher, Patrick O'Neill, Kathleen McAuley,
Rita Smyth, Mary Horan, Mathai Mani.

MASS INTENTIONS THIS WEEK

Sat 15th	6.00pm	Billy Moran M/M Michael McCorry
Sun 16th	9.00am	Angela McClelland & Jim Curran
	11.00am	Martin Brogan M/Mind Raymond Hassan
Mon 17th	9.45am	William Burns
Tues 18 th	9.45am	Mary Horan
Wed 19 th	9.45am	Patrick Hughes
Thur 20 th	9.45am	Veronica Mulholland
Fri 21 st	9.45am	Baby Michael McKee
Sat 22 nd	9.45am	William McCotter

We welcome

Alivia O'Neill

recently baptised in the parish.



NO Divine Mercy in JULY & AUGUST
Back to normal for September.
Baptisms on a Sunday will be at
12.30pm.

ST BERNARD'S SITE RE-OPENS

FEAST OF THE ASSUMPTION Mass on the 15TH
August at **12.00 noon** in **St. Bernard's Church**

Sunday masses will resume in St Bernard's Church
Saturday 15th August vigil 6pm, Sunday 16th August
9am & 11am and baptisms at 12.30pm. No 12.30pm
mass as we are still in the Summer Schedule.

**However, there will be only limited parking in the
top carpark at St Bernard's.** While the tarmac will be
finished the lining of the top carpark will not take
place until Tuesday 19th August. Some of the top
carpark will not be available for parking; **the area
nearest the steps leading to the Church will NOT BE
OPEN and the GREEN GATES WILL REMAIN CLOSED.**
The rest of the top carpark is usable but will not be
lined.

To help with parking we have permission to use the
school carpark, on the right of the laneway leading to
the church, until the lining in the top carpark is
completed.

**Weekday masses will remain in St Marys on the Hill
Monday 17th & Tuesday 18th August and resume in
St Bernard's on Wednesday 19th August 9.45am.**

SUMMER SCHEDULE JULY & AUGUST

St Bernard's Vigil	6.00pm
St Bernard's	9.00am
St Mary's on the Hill	10.00am
St Bernard's	11.00am
St Bernard's	12.30pm

Mass Times This Week



Monday 10.00am Eucharistic Prayer

Service

Tuesday – Friday 10.00am Mass

Wednesday 7.00pm Novena Mass

Saturday 5.00pm Vigil

Sunday 11.00am Mass



Adoration of The Blessed Sacrament will take place after 10.00am Mass on Wednesday & Friday



Sunday evenings from 6.00–7.30pm, a time of intercession for vocations, with a special hour of prayer and reflection. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament throughout. All are very welcome.

St Michael the Archangel Parish Bulletin



6th September 2026

Twenty-Third Sunday In Ordinary Times

Sunday Cycle A, Weekday Cycle 2 Psalter

Week 3

Parish Contact Options

CALL 02895 904304 To connect
and choose the option for the assistance you
require

PARISH OFFICE Option 1

IN THE CASE OF A SICK CALL Option 2

FUNERAL ARRANGEMENTS Option 3

MASS TIMES AND INFORMATION Option 4

FOR FATHER CIARAN FEENEY Option 5

The Parish Office will be open Monday – Thursday
9.30am–12.00pm

In the event of an emergency please call the

Vicariate Mobile on 07549209775

Webcam: Churchmedia.tv or

saintmichaelthearchangel.godaddysites.com

Facebook [Saint Michael the Archangel Parish](#)

Twitter/X [@St-MichaelArch](#)

Email: stmichaels@downandconnor.org



We pray for all our deceased relatives and
friends and for those whose
anniversaries occur at this time.

Anniversaries: Agnes Wasson, Gerry McCann,
Kathleen Hill, Stephen Reynolds, Hugh
McConville, Catherine & Thomas Doyle, Gerald
& Bernard Rafferty, John & Ellen McAlinden,
Bernard McNamee, Charlie O'Donnell.

Months Mind: Joe Hunter

Recently Deceased: Jacqueline Madden

You can book an anniversary Mass or give an
anniversary intention for this section of the
bulletin by calling or e-mailing the parish office
02895 904304 (Option 1)

Email: stmichaels@downandconnor.org



When we look at the Cross, we know how
much Jesus loved us.

When we look at the tabernacle, we know how
much Jesus loves us now.

_ St. Teresa of Calcutta

Sacred Host, greatest aid to holiness, have
mercy on us!



St Michael the Archangel Parish Golden Jubilee Celebrations

To celebrate the 50th Anniversary of St Michael the Archangel Parish, we invite our parishioners and parish family to save the following dates as we look forward to 5 days of Jubilee events this September.

Jubilee Masses

Saturday 26th September at 5.00pm

Sunday 27th September at 11.00am

These special Jubilee Masses will be followed by refreshments in the Parish Hall.

Jubilee Parish Mission

Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday 28th & 30th September at 7.00pm, with Mass each evening. We are delighted to welcome Michelle Moran as our Jubilee Mission speaker.

Michelle Moran is an internationally renowned Catholic speaker, evangelist and co-founder of the Sion Community.

Michelle will also share with our school pupils and staff over those 3 days encouraging them in their faith journey.

Further events will take place throughout our Jubilee Year, including a pilgrimage to St Patrick's Country in Downpatrick next year.

Details of these and other celebrations will be announced in due course.

Please keep these dates free and join us as we give thanks for 50 years of parish life and look forward with hope to the future!



The Offertory Collection for the 30th August amounted to £2514.45

Thank you

TO MAKE A DONATION TO THE PARISH PLEASE VISIT OUR WEBSITE

stmichaelsbelfast.co.uk and click on the **DONATE BUTTON**

Thank you for your continuous support and Generosity

Parish Draw 2026/27 News



Promoter packs are available for collection from the Committee Room beside the Sacristy. Please contact Catherine if you have any queries.

Thank you for your continued support.



This week the sanctuary lamp burns this week in loving memory of Mary & Tommy McGrath

THE WEST BELFAST HISTORICAL SOCIETY

The September meeting will take place on Friday the 11th of September at 7.30pm in St.

Michael's Parish Centre.

The September talk is entitled:

"The Lusitania and the U Boat Campaign 1914 -1918"

The guest speaker will be Mr Michael McConway
Refreshments will be provided.

(This Talk will be preceded at 7pm with the Annual General Meeting of the Society. It is important that all members of the society are in attendance for this important meeting)

Beginning Experience

Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November. The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential.

To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

MATT TALBOT – URBAN MYSTIC

The Knights of St Columbanus, CK12

Downpatrick, invite you to a special screening of
Matt Talbot – Urban Mystic at Newcastle
Community Cinema, St Mary's Hall, Main Street,
Newcastle, on Friday 4th September at 7.00pm.

Matt Talbot's remarkable true story of faith,
struggle, addiction and redemption continues to
inspire people throughout the world and offers a
powerful message of hope to those affected by
addiction and their families.

The evening will also feature **guest speaker**

Michael Murphy.

Admission is free, with a suggested donation of
£3 towards costs. Tea and coffee will be served
following the screening.

Everyone is very welcome – please bring family
and friends.

St Joseph Men's Camino

Every Camino changes us in ways we don't
expect, every man needs one. Join men from
across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for
a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley,
beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass,
Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch
and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark
Quinn.

Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student €
55). Registration, accommodation and details:

www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries:
op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

Catholic Men's Retreat – Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at

Portglenone Monastery on **Saturday 19**

September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who
live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians
2:20).

The morning will include prayer, teaching,
fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie
McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey
on 07967 620435 or email

sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

**Congratulations to all our winners this
month!**



Parish Draw for July 2026

1st Prize £500.00 Patrick McArdle

2nd Prize £100.00 Cliodhna Rooney

3rd Prize £100.00 Frances McMahon

4th Prize £100.00 Hugh McConville

5th Prize £100.00 Margaret Hollywood

Promoters Prize £50.00 Anne Duffy

Thank you to all who contribute to the
parish draw.



August & September 2026 @ Lough Derg
*A pilgrimage has a vital part to play in our life
of faith, for it removes us from our daily
routines, and gives us time and space to
encounter God more deeply.*

Pope Leo XIV

**One Day Retreats – Guided Days of Prayer and
Reflection – places available on**

Sept. 5th, 6th, 9th, 12th, 15th, 19th & 20th

Admission €50. Group discounts available.

Advance Booking Essential .

Includes Special Themed Retreats:

23rd August – St Peregrine

5th September – Pioneer Pilgrimage

6th September – St Carlos Acutis

9th & 12th September – Vocations Monstrance

19th September – Divine Mercy Pilgrimage

**Lakeshore Pilgrim Path Pilgrimage – In the
footsteps of pilgrims through the centuries**
**Sunday 30th August. 8km & 12km routes, fully
guided. Outdoor Mass weather permitting.**
Admission €25. Advance Booking Essential.

NEW FOR 2026 SEASON –Overnight
accommodation available on Station Island the
night before beginning a Retreat or Pilgrimage.
Lough Derg, Pettigo, Co Donegal. F94 PC60
www.loughderg.org email. info@loughderg.org Tel.
0719861518

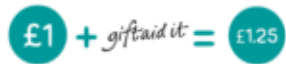
*Abide in His Love Women's Conference. The
Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran, 20-22
November 2026.*

Join women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring speakers including Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Fr Mark Wharton, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Oisín Martin, the Dominican Sisters of Nashville, Bishop Fintan Gavin, and more.

A conference not to be missed!

Register

now: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com>



Making your donations go further with no extra cost to you!

Did you know you can GIFT AID your collections to the Parish? Donating through Gift Aid means we can claim an extra 25p for every £1 you give. It will not cost you any extra. If you pay tax, even a tiny amount on a small pension, we can claim an extra 25p in each £1 you donate to St Michael's Parish. Interested in hearing more? Call in or give us a call.

If you already contribute through the envelope system or by standing order and are a tax payer who would like to gift aid your donations please complete one of the gift aid declarations and return to the office.



PARISH BULLETIN

Sunday 6 September 2026
Twenty Third Sunday in Ordinary Time

Fr Francis O'Brien

CONTACTS

Parish Office: 028 90 324597

Address: 199 Donegall Street, Belfast, BT1 2FL

Emergency Telephone: 07496818511.

Office hours 10.30am – 2.00pm Tuesday -Thursday, closes 1pm on Friday.

You can contact us by telephone or email. Since St Patrick's is a very busy Parish Office; we can't always answer the phone immediately. Please leave a message with your telephone number and we will call you back.

Parish email: stpatricks@downandconnor.org

Website: www.stpatricks.org

 [St. Patrick's Parish, Belfast | Belfast | Facebook](#)

 [@stpatricks200](#)

St Patrick's Parish is a member of a Family of Parishes comprising the Parishes of Holy Family, St Gerards and St Patrick's.

Holy Family – Fr Michael Spence, Fr John O' Lavery (028 90 743119)

St Gerards – Fr Patrick O'Keeffe (028 90 774833)

Belfast Jesuit Centre: Fr Gerry Clarke SJ
gclarke@jesuit.ie

St Patrick's Primary School: 028 90 351478

Blessed Trinity College: 028 90 370665

WEEKEND MASS

Saturday Vigil 6pm. Sunday Morning 9am & 11am.

Sunday Evening 6pm Candlelit Mass.

WEEKDAY MASS Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday 10am.

CONFESSIONS Saturdays 5.30pm to 5.50pm.

REST IN PEACE

Inurnment: Jim Meighan.



MASS INTENTIONS FOR THE COMING WEEK

Saturday 6pm: Jim Meighan Months Mind, In Memory of Deceased Members of the Cosgrove Family.

Sunday 9am: Albert Gibson Anniversary.

Sunday 6pm: Eddie Brannigan 3rd Anniversary.

Tuesday 10am: Seamus Brady Anniversary, In Memory of James and Jean Flanagan.

Wednesday 10am: In Memory of Annie and George Madine.

BAPTISMS IN ST PATRICKS

We welcomed to the Family of God this Summer.....

Caiden, Rosie Mae, Harper, Olivia, Kayden, Ava and Eadaoin. *As a Parish we pray that the Lord protects them, strengthens them and helps them continue shining their light.*

FEAST/MEMORIAL DAYS THIS WEEK

Tuesday 8 September – The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary. We celebrate the Nativity of Mary, who brought the dawn of hope and salvation to the world. She is the true Ark of the Covenant, the Temple of God, because her body received the one Mediator.

Wednesday 9 September - St Ciaran, was born in Roscommon around 512. He came to Clonmacnoise in January 545 where he founded a monastery which was to become one of the most renowned in Europe. He died at the age of 33 while the monastery was still being built.

Thursday 10 September - St Peter Claver, born in Catalonia 1580, a member of the Society of Jesus (Jesuits). In 1610 he was sent to Cartagena in Colombia and worked for 33 years among the slaves until his death in 1654. During a tireless ministry he is said to have baptised more than 300,000.

Saturday 12 September - The Most Holy Name of Mary. This Feast was included in the Roman Calendar in 1684 to celebrate the victory over the Turks at Vienna in 1683.

NEW LODGE GROTTTO 50th BIRTHDAY CELEBRATIONS

Monday 7 September

6.30pm Rosary at the Grotto

7pm Holy Mass at the Grotto

Followed by Refreshments. **All**

Welcome! With Fr Francis O'Brien and Fr John O'Lavery.



TWENTY THIRD SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

On Fraternal Correction

The question in today's Gospel is not forgiveness, but the sin of one member of the community. Every effort is to be made to bring the erring person to repentance, first in private, then before a few, finally, before the whole community. If he is still unrepentant, he must be excommunicated. The decision of the Church will be honoured by God, since God inspired them in making that decision. The harsh phrase 'treat him as a pagan or a tax collector' reflects the strict Jewish Christianity of Matthew's Church. The First Reading talks about the grave responsibility leaders of the community have to try to correct the erring.

READINGS: First Reading (Ezek 33:7-9). The appointed leaders bear the responsibility to point out to wrong-doers the error of their ways and to try to get them to reform. Second Reading (Rom 13:8-10). If we truly loved our neighbours, we would not harm them in any way. Gospel (Mt 18:15-20). We hear about the duty of a Christian to correct an erring brother or sister. But there is a proper way of doing it.

OPENING MASS FOR THE SEASON OF CREATION

Sunday, 6th September 6pm in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson marking the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept-4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water".

RCIA A JOURNEY IN FAITH

Thinking about becoming a Catholic, or wanting to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation and community for adults wishing to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith.

The 2026-2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23 September in St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion and time for questions.

All are welcome, whether you are exploring the faith for the first time or returning after time away.

To find out more email rcia@downandconnor.org

DOWN & CONNOR DIOCESAN RETREAT

13TH – 16TH SEPTEMBER As Fr Francis will be attending the retreat there will be no weekday Mass Tuesday 15 and Wednesday 16 September.

PRAYER OF THE WEEK

We wish all the students and teachers of the schools in our Parish best wishes for the new school year.

A BACK-TO-SCHOOL PRAYER

Loving God, thank you for the rest and relaxation we enjoyed over the summer.

Today, we pray for our children as they begin their new school year.

Bless them with joy at seeing friends, excitement at new experiences, and a love of learning. Watch over all who learn, replacing fear with joy, anxiety with peace, and tiredness with energy.

Grant teachers wisdom, patience, and joy in serving their students.

In Jesus' name we pray.

Amen.

THOUGHT FOR THE WEEK

"September is a gentle reminder: you are capable of change."

NOT DEAD YET UK

There are cards available in the Church to vote against the **Second Reading of The Assisted Dying Bill**. Please lend your support to those campaigning for disabled people to be assisted in living, not dying. **The Second Reading of the Bill in the House of Commons takes place on September 11**, please fill in and send your vote against it before that date.

PARISH COLLECTIONS

The Offertory Collection for Sunday 30 August came to £1866.00. Dona £135.00.

XX

If you wish to donate directly via Bank Transfer the parish bank details are:

Account Name: St Patricks Parish

Account Number: 70327727

Sort Code: 95-06-79 (please add an identifying name to your transaction) or you can contact the Parish Office for a Standing Order Form.

Thank you for your continued support and generosity.



PARISH OF ST TERESA OF ÁVILA

Web Page: www.stteresasparish.church stteresas@downandconnor.org

Black Mountain Family of Parishes

Fr Gabriel Lyons 028 9061 2855 g.lyons@downandconnor.org

Parish Office open Tuesday, Wednesday & Thursday 9am to 3pm.

6 September 2026, Twenty Third Sunday of Ordinary Time, Year A.

Sunday Gospel *In any group, small and big, things cause friction. Everyone thinks his or her way is right. We can fight over who is right. Some things are worth a fight, others not. In the big questions of life, we need the advice, support and love of the other. Many people ask themselves, "Why I didn't give an honest opinion about a decision like marriage or a job or a course of studies which seemed ill-advised to everyone?" We all have good and not-so-good tendencies. We can only advise as best we can, sensitively and wisely, and hope we get a hearing. We are afraid to hurt, to be rejected. Why do we let so many people drink themselves into trouble and never tell them? The terror of a neighbourhood, no matter what age, needs to be confronted. The problem of drugs in a neighbourhood is not confronted. Crime is not reported. In small and big things we are each others' keepers. Jesus is saying something like that today. Parents can find this difficult as they try to guide the family well and not lose them. We have social responsibility in the family and in the neighbourhood and even worldwide for the common good. (Fr D Neary)*

Please note, St Teresa's Church will be closed from Monday 7 September 2026 until Saturday 12 September 2026. It will take 5 days to repair the sanctuary steps that were vandalised in November 2025.

Sunday Masses Church of the Holy Spirit (Sat.) Vigil 5pm, St Matthias' 10am, St Teresa's 12noon.

Weekday Masses St Matthias Monday 7pm, Tuesday 10am, Wednesday 10am, Thursday 10am, Friday 7am & 10am, Saturday 10am.

Confessions Saturday 4 30pm in Church of the Holy Spirit, after any Mass and on request.

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament every Wednesday in St Matthias' Church from 11am to 4pm.

To book an Anniversary Mass, Baptism or Wedding Ceremony please email the Parish Office.

Recently Deceased Martin McKenna, Andrew Campbell.

Months Mind Maureen McCrossan

Anniversaries, Mary McDermot, Desmond Nugent, Catherine Morrison, Sr Catherine O'Connor, Rosie Glover, Andrew Murray.